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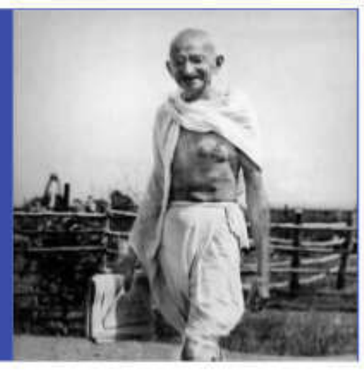

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Captain Smit Machchhar hailed for averting 9/11-like attack

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

Captain Smit Machchhar, the Flydubai pilot who fought off an apparent attempt by his copilot to crash the Israel-bound plane on Wednesday, has been hailed as a hero, with his actions to thwart the disaster drawing praise.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday called Captain Machchhar a "hero", saying his extraordinary courage in confronting the violent cockpit attack helped prevent what could have been another 9/11-like aviation tragedy and save the lives of 174 people on board.

In a post on X, Mr Modi said Capt. Machchhar had displayed "the highest form of courage" by confronting the danger despite the threat to his own life. "Captain Smit Machchhar has shown the world the highest form of courage. Without fearing for his own life, he fought valiantly and prevented another 9/11 like attack from happening. 140 crore Indians salute Captain Smit and are praying for his well-being," Mr Modi wrote.

Mr Modi also spoke over the phone with the wife and parents of Captain Machchhar.

Hailing Capt. Machchhar, President Droupadi Murmu in a post on X, said: "The nation is proud of Captain Smit Machchhar. His heroic courage and incredible presence of mind have deeply touched us all."

Political leaders from across the spectrum also praised Capt. Machchhar, including Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge and West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu also praised Capt. Machchhar, describing his actions as instrumental in preventing a catastrophic mid-air disaster.

Capt. Machchhar was taken to a hospital in Tabuk after the emergency landing. Reports later said that he underwent surgery.

'As a pilot I was simply doing my duty'

NEHA PURAV
Mumbai, 1 October

Displaying extraordinary grit and courage under horrific circumstances, Mumbai-born Indian pilot Captain Smit Machchhar, a resident of Bhanushali Wadi in Ghatkopar, saved the lives of over 170 passengers by thwarting an alleged mid-air hijacking and crash attempt by his co-pilot aboard a Flydubai flight.

Reflecting on the terrifying experience, Captain Machchhar remained remarkably humble while giving his reaction to this correspondent: "As a pilot, I was simply doing my duty. The plane landed safely, and everyone is out of harm's way ~ that is all I am grateful for."

The harrowing incident unfolded on a Flydubai flight travelling from Dubai to Israel. Mid-flight, the Omani co-pilot abruptly turned hostile, reportedly attacking Captain Machchhar and attempting to hijack and crash the aircraft in what Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu later termed a potential 9/11-style suicide attack.

Despite sustaining severe injuries, Captain Machchhar fought back fiercely, managed to trigger emergency protocols, and ensured the cockpit door was unlocked. This allowed alert crew members and brave passengers to rush in, overpower the attacker, and stabilise the aircraft before it made an emergency landing.

Captain Smit Machchhar, a veteran commercial aviator with over 9,700 flying hours, has roots in Ghatkopar, Mumbai.

At UPSC centenary celebrations, PM Modi calls for 'Nation First, Citizen First' in public service

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday participated in the centenary celebrations of the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) in New Delhi, marking 100 years of the institution and the culmination of year-long commemorative events that began on 1 October last year.

Addressing the gathering, Mr Modi described the occasion as not merely a celebration of the UPSC's century-long journey but also of the institutional legacy and public trust associated with it. "Today is a celebration of 100 years of the UPSC, but it is also a celebration of a legacy. It is a celebration of the aspiration that millions of young people hold every year," he said, adding: "It is a celebration of the trust that every Indian has in this institution."

The PM said the functioning of public institutions and the recruitment of public servants must remain anchored in two fundamental principles ~ "Nation First" and "Citizen First". He emphasised that the civil services should attract young people motivated by the opportunity to serve society rather than the status associated with holding public office.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi addresses the UPSC centenary celebration at Bharat Mandapam, in New Delhi on Thursday. IANS

He said the recruitment process should go beyond testing a candidate's knowledge and seek to understand the motivation and commitment that drives a young person to enter the civil services. "We have to bring such youth into public services who are attracted not by public office, but by public service," he said, adding that the recruitment examination should assess not only "how much a candidate knows" but also "why that young person wants to enter the civil services".

Underlining the importance of citizen-centric governance, Mr Modi invoked the traditional expression "Nagrik Devo Bhava", saying that citizens must remain at the centre of the public administration. "Our mantra is Nagrik Devo Bhava. This means that for us, the citizen of the country is no less than a deity. For us, service to the citizen is paramount," he said.

The PM said India in the 21st century was moving forward with a new work culture whose central principles were "Pro-People, Pro-Active, Good Governance".

Centre tightens sugar stock rules ahead of festive season

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

The government has tightened sugar stockholding norms from 15 October to ensure adequate availability and keep prices under check during the festive season, as the new sugar season begins from 1 October.

Under the revised rules, sugar dealers will be allowed to hold stocks for a maximum of 15 days from the date of receipt. The stockholding limit has also been capped at 1,000 quintals at any location across the country. The revised restrictions will remain in force from 15 October to 30 November 2026, with specific exemptions for Kolkata and its extended metropolitan areas and Assam.

For Kolkata and its extended metropolitan areas as well as Assam, the government has set a higher stockholding limit of 2,000 quintals.

School picnic turns tragic as eight students drown in Maha's Raigad

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Raigad, 1 October

Eight students who were out on a picnic, drowned after venturing into the sea at Diveagar beach in Maharashtra's Raigad district on Thursday, officials said. According to officials, a group of 48 people were on a visit to Dighi-Sagari beach in Diveagar for an excursion on Thursday evening.

The group comprised 25 boys, 17 girls, and 6 teachers from 'Winners Academy for 11th and 12th' in Pune's Alandi area.

During the visit, eight students ventured into the sea and were swept away after they apparently misjudged the depth of the water and current.

Reacting instantly, Bhau Salunkhe, owner of 'Bhau Maruti Salunkhe Mahakali Water Sports' at Diveagar, along with his team, launched an immediate rescue operation. Risking their own lives, the water sports team managed to retrieve the bodies of all eight victims from the sea, *NDTV* reported.

The media report added that upon receiving information about the tragedy, Assistant Police Inspector Santosh Awati from the Dighi Sagari Borli Panchatan Police Station rushed to the spot with a team. With the assistance of local villagers, the police took custody of the bodies and sent them to the Primary Health Centre in Borli Panchatan for post-mortem examinations.

The deceased students have been identified as Tanmay Dattatray Vahile, Sumit Bharat Ahire, Pranav Ramdas Bansode, Kaivalya Satish Vasankar, Rajveer Yuvraj Vahile, Yash Kiran Wankhede, Soham Tukaram Bhandwalkar, and Kaustubh Sandeep Daund.

Officials have confirmed that all the deceased students were 16 years of age and residents of Alandi in Pune.

Investigators said that further proceedings in the case are underway.

The incident took place days after a similar tragedy in Jharkhand claimed the lives of three young children.

The children drowned to death in a pond at Chegayadih village under Jamtara Sadar police station limits in Jharkhand, officials said.

They had gone to play together in the afternoon and later wandered towards a village pond located in the Chirkutola area.

India's Q2 growth seen at 7.3 per cent, global risks test outlook: Finance Ministry

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

India's economy is expected to grow by 7.3 per cent in the second quarter of FY27, supported by resilient domestic demand and investment, but higher oil prices, tightening global financial conditions and trade uncertainty pose challenges to sustaining momentum, the Ministry of Finance said in its Monthly Economic Review for September 2026.

The review said the economy entered the second quarter from a position of strength after recording 7.8 per cent growth in the first quarter, the highest first-quarter growth in the current series. However, it cautioned that India cannot take its growth performance for granted as geopolitical polarisation and disruptions across global supply chains intensify.

"Our nowcasting measure, unveiled in the Economic Survey earlier this year, anticipates a real GDP growth rate of 7.3 per cent in the fiscal second quarter," the review said.

High-frequency indicators suggest that growth has continued into the second quarter, although at a more measured pace. E-way bill generation and manufacturing activity have moderated, while services activity strengthened in August, supported by new business and employment.

Healthy growth in electricity and fuel consumption, sustained bank credit expansion and stronger production of capital and infrastructure goods point to continued investment momentum. Automobile sales across rural and urban markets also indicate broad-based consumption demand, the ministry said.

The investment rate reached its highest level in the current series in the first quarter. Manufacturing grew by 9.2 per cent, while services expanded by 10 per cent, underscoring the breadth of the economic expansion.

The review also outlined a strong export outlook, with total merchandise and services exports rising by 15.5 per cent year-on-year to USD 399.3 billion during April-August FY27.

"At the current run rate of nearly USD 400 billion in the first five months of the year, India's overall export value for the full financial year could approach a trillion US dollar," it said.

The ministry linked this momentum to India's trade agreements and said further agreements could provide additional support. In August, merchandise exports grew by 26.1 per cent, while the services trade surplus offset 65 per cent of the merchandise trade deficit.

Tata Sons board unlikely to clear Noel Tata's proposal to restructure the holding company

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai, 1 October

The Tata Sons board is unlikely to clear a proposal sent by Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata (*photo*) to the Tata Sons board to consider and approve a strategic reorganisation which would take Tata Sons outside the regulatory framework which triggered the RBI's directive to list the holding company on the stock exchange, sources said here on Thursday.

Earlier, Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata sent a proposal to the Tata Sons board to consider and approve a strategic reorganisation involving the merger of Tata Electronics Systems Solutions Pvt Ltd (TESS) and Tata Consulting Engineers (TCE) with the holding company, Tata Sons.

Noel Tata proposed the move since it would take Tata Sons outside and beyond the regulatory framework which triggered off the RBI's directive to list the company on the stock exchange, sources said.

However, Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) vice-chairmen and trustees Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh have questioned the process through which the Tata Trusts sent the proposal.

Both Venu Srinivasan and

Vijay Singh have already approached the Charity Commissioner of Maharashtra requesting an investigation into the affairs of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) which function under Tata Trusts. Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh are known to support listing Tata Sons on the stock exchange, as directed by the RBI.

In terms of the voting support inside the Tata Sons board, Noel Tata is being opposed by five Tata Sons directors who incidentally don't own even a single share in Tata Sons, yet happen to be on the Tata Sons board because of the benevolence of the late Tata Sons Chairman Emeritus Ratan Tata, sources said.

Tata Sons is scheduled to hold its annual general meeting (AGM) before December, and the issue of the continuance of N Chandrasekaran as Executive Director of the Tata Sons holding company will be decided at the AGM.

However, since Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) vice-chairmen and trustees Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh have already requested the Charity Commissioner of Maharashtra to investigate the affairs of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), there may be complications at the AGM, sources said.

In fact, the move by Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh to write to the Charity Commissioner of Maharashtra is being seen as a deliberate and well-timed attempt to block Tata Trusts from exercising its voting rights at the AGM, though the Tata Trusts collectively hold a 66 per cent stake in Tata Sons.

HDFC Bank names ICICI veteran Anup Bagchi new MD and CEO

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

HDFC Bank has appointed Anup Bagchi as its next Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer, bringing an end to the closely watched succession process at the country's largest private-sector lender.

The appointment follows approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), with Mr Bagchi set to take charge after the retirement of incumbent MD & CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan.

The RBI approved Me Bagchi's appointment and his remuneration on 1 October, 2026. HDFC Bank's board has appointed him as an Additional Director from 2 October, while his three-year term as MD & CEO will begin on 27 October, subject to shareholder approval.

Mr Bagchi is a veteran of the ICICI Group and brings more than three decades of experience across banking, financial services and capital markets. He joined ICICI Limited in 1992 and over the course of his career has worked across retail banking, corporate and investment banking, treasury, credit policy and data analytics. He holds an engineering degree from IIT Kanpur and a management degree from IIM Bangalore.

Mr Bagchi has also held senior leadership positions within the ICICI Group. He became Managing Director and CEO of ICICI Securities in 2011 and was associated with the expansion of its retail and institutional broking, financial-product distribution, wealth-management and corporate-finance businesses.

HDFC Bank's appointment of Anup Bagchi as its next Managing Director and CEO comes after a turbulent year for the lender, marked by an abrupt chairman exit, questions around corporate governance, scrutiny of internal practices and uncertainty over the succession of Sashidhar Jagdishan.

The leadership transition is particularly significant because Mr Jagdishan's tenure was already nearing its scheduled end on 26 October 2026. The bank had initially been expected to go through a routine succession process, but developments at the board level earlier this year added another layer of uncertainty.

Shinde appeals for simple celebrations, urges diversion of festival funds to drought-hit farmers

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai, 01 October

SHINDE FURTHER SAID THOUSANDS OF FARMERS WERE DISTRESSED AS THEY STRUGGLED WITH THE SEVERE DROUGHT-LIKE SITUATION.

Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde today appealed to people, Shiv Sena functionaries and social organisations to celebrate the upcoming Navratri and other religious and cultural festivals in a simple manner and divert the saved money towards helping drought-affected farmers.

In a post on X, Shinde said the state's farmers were facing a difficult situation as inadequate rainfall had damaged crops in several areas. "The rain has betrayed us this year and nature has unleashed its fury, causing the standing crops to wither and droop at several places."

Shinde further said thousands of farmers were distressed as they struggled with the severe drought-like situation. Standing firmly by the farmers, whom he described as the providers of the nation's food, was the moral and social responsibility of society, he said.

"I have always maintained that the first right over the state treasury belongs to our farmers," Shinde said, while expressing that the Mahayuti government and the Shiv Sena were firmly behind the farming community.

The government was providing all possible assistance, but society as a whole should also extend support to farmers in distress, he maintained.

Shinde said that in such a situation, celebrating upcoming religious and cultural festivals on a grand scale would not be appropriate for the members of society when farmers were facing financial and crop-related difficulties.

He appealed to Shiv Sena office-bearers, social organisations and citizens to organise Navratri and other forthcoming festivals, functions and cultural programmes on a modest scale.

He further urged organisers to contribute the funds saved from such celebrations towards the assistance and rehabilitation of drought-hit farmers.

"If we all stand firmly with our food providers during this crisis, we can certainly overcome this natural calamity," Shinde hoped. He added that if the money saved on this year's celebrations could help wipe the tears of farmers and bring happiness to their faces, it would constitute the true service of Goddess Jagdamba.

Man posing as RTI activist held for extorting Rs 1.35 lakh from Navi Mumbai builder

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai, 01 October

Rabale police have arrested a 47-year-old man for allegedly posing as an RTI activist and extorting Rs 1.35 lakh from a builder by threatening to lodge complaints against his construction projects and implicate him in false criminal cases, officials said.

The accused has been identified as Tribhuvan Lalbihari Singh, a resident of Digha. Police said the alleged extortion began in the first week of May 2026, when Singh allegedly targeted the construction sites of complainant Jitendra Pratap Singh in Airoli and Digha.

According to the complaint, the accused allegedly threatened to lodge complaints against the projects with the Navi Mumbai Municipal Corporation (NMMC), CIDCO and MIDC, warning that such action could result in the demolition of the construction and cause financial losses to the builder.

Police further alleged that Singh threatened the builder and his son with physical assault and warned that the son would be implicated in a false criminal case if the demands were not met.

Fearing action against his projects, the builder allegedly paid Singh Rs 1.35 lakh through a combination of cash and online transfers, police said.

However, the alleged demands continued, with Singh subsequently seeking another Rs 5,000, prompting the builder to approach the police and lodge a complaint. Following the complaint, Rabale police registered an FIR under Sections 308(5), 351(2) and 352 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), relating to extortion, criminal intimidation and intentional insult with intent to provoke a breach of peace.

Police said the allegations that Singh threatened to approach civic and development authorities are being investigated, and it has not been indicated that the threatened complaints were actually filed.

Police are examining the alleged cash and online payments, the threats made to the builder and his son, and other circumstances surrounding the case. Officials also said Singh has previous cases registered against him, including allegations involving extortion, assault and intimidation.

BRIEFLY

Pune residential market expands towards Vadgaon

Pune: Pune's residential market continued to remain active in the first half of 2026, with housing demand expanding across both established and emerging residential corridors, including the Sinhgad Road-Vadgaon belt. The Sinhgad Road-Vadgaon corridor has emerged as a residential destination, supported by access to educational institutions, healthcare facilities, retail outlets and other civic amenities. Planned improvements in the city's road and transport infrastructure are also expected to strengthen connectivity in the region. Against this backdrop, Kolte-Patil Developers' 'The Reserve' is being developed across more than 20 acres, around 400 metres from Sinhgad Road. The project is located near the Mutha River and offers views of the NDA Hills. The development is planned in multiple phases, with a potential saleable area of around 5 million sq ft and an estimated gross development value (GDV) of approximately Rs 4,000 crore. According to the developer, more than 600 apartments were booked within 60 hours of the project's launch, generating sales of over Rs 600 crore. Pranav Mehta, Chief Business Officer - Pune, Kolte-Patil Developers, said the project seeks to bring together space, quality and amenities, with a focus on execution and timely delivery.

ED searches nine Yavatmal locations in Rs 242 cr Co-op Bank fraud case

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai, 01 October

The Enforcement Directorate (ED), Mumbai Zone, on Wednesday conducted searches at nine locations in Yavatmal district in connection with an alleged Rs 242 crore fraud at Babaji Date Mahila Sahakari Bank.

The searches were carried out under the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), the agency said. The case follows multiple FIRs registered at Avdhutwadi Police Station, Yavatmal, against bank officials, employees and borrowers over alleged irregularities in loan disbursement. A special audit ordered by the Maharashtra government had flagged alleged irregularities in loans sanctioned by the then CEO, chairperson/chairman, directors and other officials of the bank. According to the ED, bank officials allegedly colluded with borrowers, valuers and auditors to sanction loans without adequate security and without properly assessing the borrowers' repayment capacity. The agency alleged that the loans were sanctioned in violation of the bank's norms, loan policy and RBI guidelines. The investigation also found, according to the ED, that loan funds were allegedly diverted for personal use, while substantial cash withdrawals were made and funds were used for evergreening of loans. The agency further alleged that part of the proceeds was routed to accounts of bank officials as commissions or kickbacks. The Reserve Bank of India had cancelled the bank's licence in 2022.

Aadhaar mandatory for 63 types of property document registrations in Maharashtra from October 1

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai, 01 October

Aadhaar identification will now be mandatory for registration of property-related documents in Maharashtra, with no document registration being permitted without a valid identity proof. Revenue Minister Chandrashekhar Bawankule said the decision has been implemented from October 1 to curb fraud in property transactions and prevent the use of fake parties and witnesses.

Speaking to the media, Bawankule said the decision was taken following directions from Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis. The measure is aimed at preventing fraudulent property transactions carried out by producing fictitious parties or witnesses. According to the Revenue Department, Aadhaar identification has been made compulsory for 63 categories of document registrations, including sale, purchase, gift, mortgage and partition of property. A government gazette notification has also been issued in this regard. Bawankule also spoke about the Surya project in Palghar, where land and houses are being acquired for the project. He said several villages, including Hanuman Nagar, had been rehabilitated in 1979, but proper land records were not available, creating difficulties in determining who should receive compensation for land acquisition. The government has now amended the relevant provisions and will prepare property cards and seven-twelve land records for the affected residents. Once the records are prepared, compensation for land acquisition will be disbursed and eligible residents will receive their plots, he said.

Bawankule said the issue relating to the Surya project had remained unresolved for several years, but the state Cabinet took a decision on it at its meeting on Wednesday.

He also said the government had decided to provide land free of cost for a housing project for needy people in Nagpur district. The initiative follows a suggestion by union Minister Nitin Gadkari to develop a "Smart Village" near an existing project.

Sagar Kavach

Maharashtra Chief Secretary Rajesh Aggarwal poses for a group photograph with an Indian Coast Guard team alongside a hovercraft of the 73 Air Cushion Vehicle Squadron during the coastal security exercise 'Sagar Kavach' at Girgaon Chowpatty, in Mumbai on Thursday.

DRI Nagpur busts inter-state drug racket, seizes amphetamine worth Rs 1.05 crore

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Nagpur, 01 October

A THOROUGH SEARCH OF THE PASSENGER'S LUGGAGE LED TO THE DISCOVERY OF A SPECIALLY FABRICATED HIDDEN CAVITY BEHIND THE INNER LINING OF A SUITCASE. INSIDE THE COMPARTMENT, OFFICERS RECOVERED TWO PACKETS WRAPPED IN BLUE CARBON PAPER AND CAREFULLY CONCEALED FROM VIEW.

The Regional Unit of Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI), Nagpur, under the Mumbai Zonal Unit, has busted an inter-state narcotics trafficking network and seized 1.312 kg of amphetamine estimated to be worth around Rs 1.05 crore in the illegal market, officials said today.

According to DRI officials, the operation was carried out on September 27 following a specific intelligence input regarding the movement of narcotic drugs through rail transport. Acting on the tip-off, officers intercepted a woman passenger travelling on board the Hazrat Nizamuddin-KSR Bengaluru Rajdhani Express (Train No. 22692) at Nagpur Railway Station. A thorough search of the passenger's luggage led to the discovery of a specially fabricated hidden cavity behind the inner lining of a suitcase. Inside the compartment, officers recovered two packets wrapped in blue carbon paper and carefully concealed from view.

Preliminary examination using a field testing kit confirmed the presence of amphetamine, a prohibited psychotropic substance. The recovered packets were found to contain a total of 1.312 kg of the drug.

The contraband, valued at approximately Rs 1.05 crore in the illicit market, was seized under the provisions of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, 1985.

The woman was subsequently arrested under the NDPS Act and produced before the Holiday Court in Nagpur on the same day, officials said.

The DRI stated that the seizure highlights its ongoing crackdown on organised drug-smuggling networks operating across states and reaffirmed its commitment to supporting the Government of India's campaign for a "Nasha Mukt Bharat".

PETA India moves SC seeking return of elephant Madhuri to Vantara

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Kolhapur, 01 October

People for the Ethical Treatment of Animals (PETA) India has approached the Supreme Court seeking its intervention for the relocation of elephant "Madhuri" from Nandani Math in Kolhapur to Vantara, alleging that the temple premises are unsuitable for her long-term welfare. PETA India, in its petition, has urged the apex court to direct that Madhuri be shifted back to Vantara, where she had earlier been housed.

PETA (The animal rights organisation said it moved the Supreme Court less than 15 days after Madhuri returned to Nandani Math in Kolhapur on September 11-12. According to PETA India, "Madhuri is subjected to loud firecrackers, screaming crowds, slogans and drums during her return to the temple. The organisation has further alleged that the elephant is currently living like a prisoner in jail as she is kept in shackles and in isolation."

"Nandani Math is not a suitable place for Madhuri, who was able to freely associate with other elephants in Vantara. She is now isolated in a shed. Experts have already concluded that the facility is not suitable for her long-term life and health," PETA India Vice-President of Policy Khushboo Gupta said. PETA India has also submitted before the Supreme Court that Madhuri's return to Nandani Math is contrary to orders passed by the Bombay High Court on July 16, 2025, and the Supreme Court on July 28, 2025.

NCP-SP backs Abhijeet Dipke's 'jail bharo' and Thackeray Brothers' mega march against EC

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai, 01 October

The opposition Maha Vikas Aghadi (MVA) has rallied behind growing protests against the Election Commission of India (ECI) over alleged irregularities in voter lists and the implementation of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

In a boost to the youth-led agitation, the Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) has extended its support to both tomorrow's 'Jail Bharo' protest and the October 4 mega march led by Raj and Uddhav Thackeray.

Speaking to reporters on the sidelines of the INDIA bloc meeting in New Delhi, NCP-SP National Working President and MP Supriya Sule announced the party's support for the October 2 statewide agitation.

"To protest against the arbitrary functioning of the Central Election Commission and to protect the democratic values of our nation, a 'Jail Bharo' agitation is being led by Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) chief Abhijeet Dipke in Mumbai tomorrow, October 2," Sule said. "Our party extends its complete support to this protest. We also fully endorse the grand mega march being spearheaded by the Thackeray brothers, Raj and Uddhav Thackeray, in Mumbai on October 4."

Dipke's 'Jail Bharo' protest at Dadar's Shivaji Park on Gandhi Jayanti has gained traction, with significant participation expected from Gen-Z voters and competitive-exam aspirants from across Maharashtra.

While NCP-SP has extended political and moral support to both protests, it remains unclear whether senior party leaders will physically join the demonstrations.

Congress leader Nana Patole has already confirmed his participation in the October 4 mega march, indicating coordinated opposition action against the poll panel.

Meanwhile, with Shivaji Park designated as a 'silent zone' and resistance reported over the proposed gathering, Mumbai Police have stepped up security and deployed additional personnel to maintain law and order.

CM Rekha Gupta urges residents to make cleanliness daily habit, shared responsibility

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta urged residents to make cleanliness a daily habit rather than restricting it to government campaigns, as she joined students, teachers and residents in a cleanliness drive at Kamla Nehru Ridge under the 'Swachhata Hi Seva Abhiyan 2026'.

Participating in the nationwide 'Ek Din, Ek Ghanta, Ek Saath' cleanliness drive on Thursday, Gupta said maintenance of public spaces should not be the sole responsibility of civic agencies. It requires sustained participation from citizens.

"Cleanliness should not be limited to a single day or a particular campaign, but should become a regular habit and a collective responsibility," she said.

Rekha Gupta joins the 'Ek Din, Ek Ghanta, Ek Saath' Swachhata Hi Seva campaign under Seva Sankalp Abhiyan at Kamla Nehru Ridge. SNS

The Chief Minister said thousands of people across Delhi participated in cleanliness and other service activities between 8 am and 9 am, the campaign's designated period.

She said citizens should recognise the impact of littering on public spaces and the environment, and develop greater sensitivity towards keeping their surroundings clean.

She said sanitation workers and civic agencies must ensure regular cleaning while the residents has a responsibility to prevent littering after an area had been cleaned. "Both the administration and citizens must play their respective roles to make the cleanliness system effective," she said.

She also highlighted the participation of Delhi University students and teachers in the drive, saying young people could play an important role in expanding such initiatives into wider public movements. She appealed to residents to make cleanliness of roads, lanes, parks, markets and other public spaces part of their everyday routine.

Meanwhile, a separate cleanliness drive was conducted by the 103 RAF Battalion at Pushpanjali School in Tukmirpur, with Cabinet Minister Kapil Mishra, local public representatives, RAF personnel, residents and school students participating.

Mishra said the 103 RAF Battalion organises such drives annually in collaboration with local residents and students. He said the initiative reflected the social responsibility of the security personnel beyond their regular duties.

According to Mishra, a cleanliness campaign was conducted at around 300 locations across Delhi on Thursday, with ministers, MLAs, councillors, public representatives and residents participating in activities in their respective areas.

He said cleanliness should be treated as a social responsibility and not remain limited to periodic campaigns. He called for continued coordination among the government, security forces, local representatives and citizens to maintain public spaces.

Students key to building clean, green and healthy Viksit Bharat 2047: Pralhad Joshi

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

JOSHI WAS SPEAKING DURING A SHRAMDAAN AND CLEANLINESS DRIVE AT GARGI COLLEGE, UNIVERSITY OF DELHI, ORGANISED UNDER THE NATIONWIDE 'EK DIN, EK GHANTA, EK SAATH' INITIATIVE. THE MINISTER ALSO PLANTED A SAPLING ON THE COLLEGE PREMISES UNDER THE 'EK PED MAA KE NAAM' CAMPAIGN.

Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi on Thursday called upon students to play a leading role in building a clean, green and healthy India by 2047, urging them to make cleanliness a sustained habit and contribute actively to public welfare. Joshi was speaking during a Shramdaan and cleanliness drive at Gargi College, University of Delhi, organised under the nationwide 'Ek Din, Ek Ghanta, Ek Saath' initiative.

The minister also planted a sapling on the college premises under the 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' campaign.

Interacting with students, Joshi said cleanliness was closely linked with public health and overall well-being and stressed the need for collective participation to make Swachhata a sustained practice. He urged students to contribute at least 30 minutes to cleanliness-oriented activities and maintain cleanliness not only in educational institutions but also at their homes and public spaces.

"Individual efforts can inspire collective action," the minister said, emphasising the need to transform Swachhata into a people's movement.

Joshi also highlighted the importance of physical fitness and outdoor activities for young people. He encouraged students to participate in sports and spend more time on playgrounds while maintaining a healthy balance with screen-based activities.

The minister said students were key pillars in translating Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of a Viksit Bharat into action and called upon them to contribute through responsible citizenship and active participation.

He said a clean, green and healthy India would require sustained efforts by citizens, particularly the youth, who have an important role in shaping the country's future.

University of Delhi Vice Chancellor Prof Yogesh Singh, faculty members of Gargi College and senior officials of the Education Ministry were present on the occasion.

J&K Govt approves ₹15 Crore restoration of traditional Shri Mata Vaishno Devi pilgrimage route

UNITED NEWS OF INDIA
Srinagar, 1 October

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah-led Government has accorded administrative approval for restoration of the traditional Shri Mata Vaishno Devi pilgrimage route at an estimated cost of Rs 15 crore, officials said on Thursday.

The Chief Minister said the restoration of the traditional route is aimed at preserving its heritage while strengthening infrastructure and improving facilities for pilgrims undertaking the revered journey.

Mata Vaishno Devi shrine is among the major pilgrimage destinations in Jammu and Kashmir, attracting millions of devotees from across the country and abroad every year.

The project will focus on restoration and improvement of the traditional route, with the objective of ensuring a smoother, safer and more convenient pilgrimage experience for devotees while preserving its historical and cultural significance.

The Chief Minister emphasised that development of pilgrimage infrastructure must go hand in hand with preservation of the heritage and traditional character of important religious sites in Jammu and Kashmir.

BJP begins two-day Punjab poll strategy meet in Panchkula

UNITED NEWS OF INDIA
Panchkula, 1 October

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Thursday began a two-day organisational meeting in Panchkula to review its preparedness and chalk out strategy for the 2027 Punjab Assembly elections.

The meeting, being held at the Red Bishop in Sector 1, is being led by BJP national general secretary (organisation) B.L. Santosh and is attended by senior Punjab BJP functionaries, district presidents and other organisational leaders.

The deliberations focus on strengthening the party organisation at the grassroots, assessing its presence across Punjab, and gathering feedback from district-level leaders ahead of the Assembly elections.

Punjab BJP president Kewal Singh Dhillon said the meeting would also review the response to the party's recently concluded anti-drug outreach campaign.

"The meeting will take stock of the response and success of the public outreach we conducted on the issue of drugs and will also discuss the strategy for the Punjab elections, due next year," Dhillon said. The BJP is also expected to assess its organisational strength, particularly in rural Punjab, and identify constituencies where it believes it can strengthen its electoral position. The meeting comes a day after the culmination of the BJP's 13-day anti-drug campaign, which covered all 117 Assembly constituencies in Punjab.

Haryana, U'khand & Punjab bag top 3 spots in voluntary blood donations

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

As the annual nationwide blood donation campaign nears its end, Haryana was awarded first place for the highest blood collection in 2025, officials from the Health Ministry said on Thursday.

Uttarakhand and Punjab grabbed the second and third spots and were felicitated during a campaign in Delhi's Lady Hardinge Medical College on the occasion of National Voluntary Blood Donation Day. The government noted these were the three best-performing states among the 21 Indian states, excluding the North-Eastern states.

In the North-Eastern region, Mizoram and Sikkim bagged the first and second places, while among the eight Union Territories in the country, Chandigarh took the first spot followed by Delhi, the officials said in a statement.

The recognition acknowledges the sustained efforts of State Blood Transfusion Councils towards donor mobilisation, expansion of voluntary donor participation and promotion of voluntary blood donation.

NGOs and organisations making significant contributions towards promotion of voluntary blood donation and strengthening blood transfusion services were also felicitated. These included Thalassaemics India; Akhil Bharatiya Terapanth Yuvak Parishad (ABTYP); All India Radio; and Indian Red Cross Society, among others.

Addressing the gathering, Dr M Srinivas, Member (Health), NITI Aayog highlighted the importance of voluntary blood donation in ensuring an adequate and sustainable blood supply. He noted that around 75 per cent of blood collection in the country is through voluntary donation. He called for concerted efforts by the government, healthcare professionals, NGOs, voluntary organisations and youth organisations to further expand voluntary blood donation and address gaps between demand and availability.

He also underscored the importance of rational and optimal utilisation of blood and its components. He called for expanding awareness on blood health beyond blood donation to include related issues such as nutrition and anaemia, particularly among women and adolescent girls.

Himachal CM announces higher milk, apple procurement prices to boost rural economy

UNITED NEWS OF INDIA
Shimla, 1 October

Chief Minister Thakur Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Thursday announced an increase in the support price of milk from December 1 and raised the procurement price of apples under the Market Intervention Scheme from Rs 12 to Rs 13 per kg, saying the measures would strengthen the rural economy and increase farmers' incomes.

Addressing a public meeting at Chirgaon in the Rohru Assembly constituency, Sukhu said the state government was making continuous efforts to strengthen the rural economy and increase the income of farmers, apple growers and livestock farmers. He said previous governments had made only small increases in milk prices, while the present state government had made a historic increase in the support price. Further increases in the future would help enhance the income of livestock farmers, he said. The Chief Minister said the Congress government was committed to rural development and had introduced the universal carton system to benefit apple growers.

Support prices were also being provided for produce from natural farming. On education, Sukhu said the previous BJP government had not paid adequate attention to the sector and claimed that Himachal Pradesh, which ranked 21st in quality education in 2021, had now moved to fifth place due to the efforts of the present government. He said English-medium education had been introduced from Class 1 in government schools and more than 150 CBSE schools had been opened in view of declining student numbers.

After CBSE curriculum was introduced in one school in Rohru, the number of students increased by more than 500 in a year, he said, adding that 1,500 teachers had been appointed in CBSE schools. He said 300 Schools of Excellence were also being developed to provide children in rural areas better education close to home and reduce the financial burden on parents.

Himachal: Bilaspur Dy Comm holds review meeting regarding preparations for Prez's proposed visit

UNITED NEWS OF INDIA
Hamirpur, 1 October

Deputy Commissioner Rahul Kumar today chaired a review meeting at the Zila Parishad Hall ahead of President Droupadi Murmu's proposed one-day visit to Bilaspur district on October 6.

During the meeting, he took a detailed review of the preparations being made by various departments for the President's visit. Superintendent of Police Abhishek Dhiman, Additional Deputy Commissioner Rupinder Kaur, and senior officials from various departments were present at the meeting.

DC Rahul Kumar stated that the visit of the President is a matter of pride for all residents of the district. During the visit, the President will pay obeisance at the Maa Naina Devi temple and also attend the first convocation ceremony of AIIMS Bilaspur.

The Deputy Commissioner instructed all officials to discharge their respective duties with utmost seriousness and responsibility to ensure no shortcomings in the arrangements during the President's visit. He directed all concerned departments-including the AIIMS administration, Public Works Department (PWD), Jal Shakti, Electricity, and Health & Family Welfare-to complete all necessary preparations within the stipulated time and according to prescribed protocols.

He emphasized that ensuring the successful and well-organized conduct of the President's visit is the collective responsibility of the district administration and all concerned departments. To this end, all officials should work with mutual coordination, synergy, and a team spirit. He added that every department must regularly review its assigned tasks and ensure their completion within the set timeframe.

Murugan joins 'Swachhata Hi Seva' activities at IIMC, urges collective responsibility for cleanliness

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

THE PROGRAMME BEGAN WITH THE ADMINISTRATION OF THE SWACHHATA PLEDGE, IN WHICH FACULTY MEMBERS, OFFICERS, STAFF, STUDENTS AND INDIAN INFORMATION SERVICE TRAINEES PARTICIPATED.

Union Minister of State for Information & Broadcasting and Parliamentary Affairs Dr L. Murugan on Thursday participated in a series of activities under the 'Swachhata Hi Seva' campaign at the Indian Institute of Mass Communication (IIMC) here, calling upon students, officials and citizens to contribute to cleanliness initiatives in institutions and public spaces.

The programme began with the administration of the Swachhata pledge, in which faculty members, officers, staff, students and Indian Information Service trainees participated.

Addressing the gathering, Murugan recalled the launch of the Swachh Bharat Mission by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2014 and said the cleanliness campaign had evolved into a people's movement with participation across the country.

"After Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi launched the cleanliness campaign in 2014, people across the country became part of this movement. Cleanliness drives were also undertaken in offices and institutions," he said.

The minister urged people to contribute to cleanliness efforts wherever possible, including at Anganwadi centres, temples, educational institutions and other public places.

"Today, along with students and officials at IIMC, we have taken the pledge for cleanliness. We should contribute through Swachhata Seva wherever possible... It is our collective responsibility to keep our country, institutions and offices clean," he said.

Murugan also participated in the 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' plantation initiative by planting a sapling on the IIMC campus. He stressed that the responsibility does not end with planting trees and that their continued care and maintenance were equally important.

He subsequently joined students, faculty members, officers and staff in a one-hour Shramdaan as part of the cleanliness drive. Participants cleared waste and construction material from designated areas on the campus.

During his visit, the minister also inspected the newly constructed classrooms and other academic and infras- tructure facilities, including the teaching block, hostel under construction and renovated library. He interacted with students from different states and departments of the institute.

Murugan appreciated the initiatives undertaken by IIMC in promoting cleanliness, environmental awareness, campus development and student participation.

IIMC Vice-Chancellor Dr Pragya Paliwal Gaur, Registrar and DG Training L Madhu Nag and Senior Economic Adviser R.K. Jena were present during the programme, along with faculty members, officers, staff, students and officer trainees.

The activities formed part of IIMC's observance of the "Swachhata Hi Seva" campaign, which seeks to promote collective participation in cleanliness, environmental conservation and responsible citizenship.

Panchkula pushes Abha IDs to expand digital health access, officials asked to enrol families

UNITED NEWS OF INDIA
Panchkula, 1 October

The Panchkula administration on Thursday stepped up efforts to expand digital health coverage under the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission, asking government officials and employees to create ABHA IDs for themselves and their family members.

A workshop on the Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA) ID was organised at the Mini Secretariat under the guidance of Deputy Commissioner Satpal Sharma to familiarise officials with the digital health system and its benefits. Sharma said the ABHA ID had been developed as a citizen's digital health identity, enabling digital maintenance of health records and facilitating better access to healthcare services.

"The ABHA ID will help keep health-related information organised digitally and make healthcare services more accessible," the Deputy Commissioner said while urging officials to create IDs for themselves and their families.

Additional Deputy Commissioner Vivek Arya also asked officers and employees attending the workshop to enrol for ABHA IDs and make use of digital health services.

ABHA Joint Director Kirti Sharma said the awareness programme aimed to connect officials and citizens with the digital health ecosystem and encourage them to maintain their health records digitally. Deputy Civil Surgeon Dr Manish said the system facilitates secure digital health records, easier access to health services and convenient sharing of health information, besides supporting better and safer healthcare.

J&K police's State Investigation Agency raids two Kashmir homes in probe into Myanmar cyber-fraud trafficking network

UNITED NEWS OF INDIA
Srinagar, 1 October

J&K police's State Investigation Agency (SIA), Kashmir, on Thursday conducted searches at two residential premises in Kulgam district in connection with a probe into an alleged transnational human trafficking network accused of luring unemployed youth with overseas job offers and subsequently exploiting them in cyber fraud operations in Myanmar.

The searches were carried out at the residence of Gulam Nabi Khanday alias Charlie, Mohsin and Jerry Khan of Bungam Chewgam, Kulgam, and Ashiq Hussain Sheikh of Baghpora Yar, Khushipora, Qazigund, SIA said.

The operation was conducted in the early hours pursuant to search warrants issued by a competent court in connection with FIR registered this year at Police Station SIA Kashmir.

During the searches, the agency seized mobile phones, identity-related documents, PAN cards, a passport and job agreements, which are being examined as part of the ongoing investigation.

SIA said that preliminary investigation has indicated that local facilitators allegedly worked in coordination with foreign-based handlers to lure unemployed and vulnerable youth with promises of overseas employment.

The victims were allegedly transported through Thailand to the Myawaddy region of Myanmar, where they were subsequently exploited and allegedly forced to participate in cyber scam operations.

THE SEARCHES WERE CARRIED OUT AT THE RESIDENCE OF GULAM NABI KHANDAY ALIAS CHARLIE, MOHSIN AND JERRY KHAN OF BUNGAM CHEWGAM, KULGAM, AND ASHIQ HUSSAIN SHEIKH OF BAGHPORA YAR, KHUSHIPORA, QAZIGUND, SIA SAID.

The SIA is investigating the alleged transnational chain involved in the recruitment, movement, facilitation and exploitation of the victims. The probe is also aimed at identifying the local and overseas linkages and tracing the financial and logistical channels allegedly supporting the network.

The agency said cooperation from national agencies and international partners has been sought in the investigation.

The digital and documentary material seized during the searches will be subjected to detailed examination to establish communication links, financial transactions, recruitment mechanisms and other evidence relevant to the case.

The SIA said the searches were part of its efforts to identify and dismantle the wider network, establish the role of each person involved and safeguard the interests of victims allegedly subjected to trafficking and exploitation.

रजिस्ट्री सं० डी० एल०–33004/99 REGD.NO. D.L.-33004/99

भारत का राजपत्र
The Gazette of India

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No. 5161] NEW DELHI, WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 30, 2026/ASVINA 8, 1948

MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS

(Northern Railway (Construction Organization))

NOTIFICATION

New Delhi, the 29th September, 2026

S.O. 5369(E). In exercise of the powers conferred by sub-section (1) of section 20A of the Railways Act, 1989 (24 of 1989) (hereinafter referred to as the said Act), the Central Government, after being satisfied that for the public purpose, the land, the brief description of which has given in the schedule annexed hereto, is required for the purpose of execution, maintenance, management and operation of the Special Railway Project namely, "Delhi-Panipat-Ambala (198 Km) Third & Fourth Line Project" in the district of Panipat in the State of Haryana, hereby declares its intention to acquire such land;

Any person interested in the said land may within a period of thirty days from the date of publication of this notification in the official Gazette, raise objection to the acquisition and use of such land for the aforesaid purpose under sub-section (1) of section 20 D of the said Act;

Every such objection shall be made to the Competent Authority, namely, District Revenue Officer, Panipat in writing and shall set out the grounds thereof and the Competent Authority shall give the objector an opportunity of being heard, either in person or by legal practitioner and may, after hearing all such objections and after making such further enquiry, if any, as the Competent Authority thinks necessary, by order, either allow or disallow the objections;

Any order made by the Competent Authority under sub-section (2) of section 20 D of the said Act shall be final;

The land plans and other details of the land covered under this notification are available and can be inspected by the interested person at the aforesaid office of the Competent Authority.

SCHEDULE

Brief description of the land to be acquired, with or without structure, for the Special Railway Project, **namely, "Delhi-Panipat-Ambala (198 Km) Third & Fourth Line Project" in the district Panipat in the state of Haryana.**

Sl. No.	Tehsil	Village name	Khasra No.	Acquisition Area (In Hect.)
1	SAMALKHA	BHODWAL MAJRI	40//20	0.1167
2			40//11	0.0852
3			40//10	0.0850
4			40//1/3	0.0166
5			40//1/1	0.0687
6			40//1/2	0.0180
7			31//20/1	0.0202
8			31//20/2	0.0884
9			31//21/1	0.0910
10			31//21/2	0.0202
Total				**0.6100**
1	SAMALKHA	CHULKANA	28//20/1	0.0001
2			28//22	0.0471
3			30//2	0.0458
4			30//9	0.0359
5			30//12	0.0273
6			30//19	0.0454
7			30//22	0.0818
8			253	0.0090
9			60//2	0.0623
10			60//9	0.0638
11			60//12	0.0779
12			60//19	0.1111
13			60//22	0.1140
14			63//2	0.0888
15			63//3	0.0574
16			63//8	0.0565
17			63//9	0.0624
18			63//12	0.0140
19			96//2	0.0086
20			96//8	0.0836
21			96//13	0.1394
22			96//18	0.1322
23			96//23	0.1168
24			99//3	0.0835
25			99//8	0.0668
26			99//13	0.0179
27			99//14	0.0430
28			99//17	0.0551
29			99//24	0.0391
30			126//4	0.0246
31			126//7	0.0105
Total				**1.8218**
1	SAMALKHA	KIWANA	99//1	0.0266
2			99//20	0.0279
3			99//11	0.0291
4			99//10	0.0270
5			99//21/1	0.0147
6			99//21/2	0.0152
7			102//20	0.0272
8			102//11	0.0214
9			102//10	0.0280
10			102//1	0.0254
Total				**0.2424**
1	SAMALKHA	MANANA	99//5	0.0230
2			99//6	0.0049
3			78//25	0.0349
4			78//16	0.0404
5			78//15	0.0419
6			78//6	0.0380
7			78//4	0.0293
8			78//5/1	0.0049
9			71//24	0.0504
10			71//17	0.0717
11			71//14	0.0750
12			71//7	0.0798
13			71//4	0.0853
14			53//18	0.0240
15			53//23/3	0.0001
16			53//23/4	0.0429
17			53//13/2/1	0.0178
18			53//13/2/2	0.0013
19			53//13/1	0.0039
20			53//9	0.0112
21			33//17	0.0027
22			33//25	0.0125
23			0//170	0.0139
Total				**0.7098**
1	SAMALKHA	KARHANS	3//24	0.0431
2			9//4/2	0.0257
3			9//4/3/1	0.0057
4			9//4/4/2	0.0106
5			9//6	0.0422
6			9//15	0.0424
7			9//25	0.0007
8			8//21	0.0138
9			9//16	0.0262
10			340	0.2861
11			16//1	0.0189
12			16//10	0.0200
13			16//11	0.0016
14			16//12	0.0193
15			16//19	0.0179
16			16//22	0.0152
17			27//2	0.0033
18			27//24	0.0139
19			27//18	0.0180
20			27//13	0.0168
21			27//3	0.0146
22			27//8	0.0159
23			32//4	0.0138
24			131	0.0057
25			32//26	0.0275
26			32//15	0.0131
27			32//16	0.0108
28			32//25	0.0081
29			33//21	0.0088
30			52//2	0.0752
31			52//8	0.0663
32			52//13	0.0697
33			52//18	0,0759
34			52//24	0.0775
35			73//4	0.0788
36			73//7	0.0851
37			73//15/1	0,0809
38			73//16	0.0602
39			49//22	0.0740
40			49//19	0.0310
41			49//11/3	0.0114
42			49//11/2	0.0121
43			49//11/1	0.0076
44			49//10/2	0.0101
45			49//10/1	0.0148
46			49//1	0.0224
47			342	0.2297
Total				**1.8425**
1	SAMALKHA	MACHHROLI	3//21	0.0013
2			16//1/1	0.0053
3			16//1/2	0.0021
4			16//19/1	0.0057
5			16//19/2	0.0033
6			16//10	0.0040
7			327	0.2392
8			16//12	0.0028
9			16//22	0.0159
10			21//3	0.0239
11			21//8/1	0.0098
12			21//8/2	0.0299
13			21//13	0.0415
14			21//17	0.0380
Total				**0.4227**
1	SAMALKHA	JHATTIPUR	37//19	0.0439
2			37//12	0.0335
3			37//22	0.0437
4			11//20	0.0536
5			11//21	0.0331
6			37//1	0.0483
7			37//10	0.0364
8			41//3	0.0184
9			41//8/2	0.0137
10			41//8/1	0.0010
11			272	0.1347
12			66//6	0.0001
13			66//15	0.0043
14			66//16	0.0043
15			91	0.0047
16			126	0.0095
17			90	0.0009
Total				**0.4842**
1	PANIPAT	DIWANA	36//11	0.0014
2			36//20	0.0129
3			41//23	0.0444
4			41//12/1	0.0086
5			41//19/1	0.0117
6			41//19/2	0.0300
7			41//12/2	0.0141
8			41//9	0.0255
9			41//1	0.0208
10			36//21	0.0192
11			91	0.0138
12			56//3	0.0444
13			56//14	0.0448
14			56//8	0.0446
15			56//17	0.0450
16			56//24	0.0453
17			59//5	0.0453
18			59//6	0.0457
19			59//15	0.0299
20			58//11	0.0044
Total				**0.5517**
1	PANIPAT	SEWAH	173//5	0.0675
2			166//25	0.0504
3			166//17	0.0401
4			166//14	0.0189
Total				**0.1769**
1	PANIPAT	KABRI	51//4	0.0034
2			51//7	0.0283
3			51//14/1	0.0121
4			51//14/2	0.0072
5			51//17	0.0608
6			51//24/2	0.0597
7			51//24/1	0.0078
8			74//4	0.1064
9			74//7/2	0.0043
10			74//7/1	0.0346
11			74//8/2	0.0547
12			74//14/2	0.0426
13			74//13	0.1167
14			74//18	0.0440
15			74//8/1	0.0185
16			741	0.1035
17			122	0.0134
Total				**0.7181**
1	PANIPAT	SARAI BACHHRA	1//25	0.0550
2			5//6	0.0361
3			5//15	0.0047
4			5//5	0.0549
Total				**0.1507**
1	PANIPAT	NIZAMPUR	106	0.0403
2			105	0.0665
3			104	0.0679
4			103	0.0261
Total				**0.2008**
1	PANIPAT	TARAF INSAAR	119	0.2090
2			120	0.0518
3			122	0.0170
4			123	0.1210
5			144	0.0904
6			147	0.0349
7			148	0.0110
Total				**0.5351**

[F. No. 190-W/Land/TKJ/DLI-UMB]
SHAILESH KUMAR MISHRA, Chief Administrative Officer/Construction

3418/2026

Classified

LEGAL NOTICES

IN THE COURT OF SH MAYANK MITTAL, Senior Civil Judge-Cum-Rent Controller (North-West), Room No. 410, 4th Floor, District Court Rohini, Delhi
CS/SCJ-436/2026

REKHA
–Plaintiff
V/S
SAM HATCHERY AGRO PVT LTD
–Defendant
TO
1. PRIYANKA MASEH DIRECTOR/OWNER OF M/S SAM HATCHERY AGRO PVT LTD. R/O A-122, FIRST FLOOR FLAT NO. 03, NEHRU NAGAR-2 GHAZIABAD, U.P. 201001
2. ARVIND PATHAK DIRECTOR OF M/S SAM HATCHERY AGRO PVT. LTD R/O FLAT NO. 02, UPPER GROUND FLOOR, PLOT NO. 122, RADHA KRISHAN ENCLAVE, INDER GARHI, GOVINDPURAM, GHAZIABAD, U.P.
3. SAMVIL MASEH SIGNING AUTHORITY/A.R. OF M/S SAM HATCHERY AGRO PVT. LTD. R/O A-122, FIRST FLOOR, FLAT NO. 03, NEHRU NAGAR-2 GHAZIABAD, U.P. 201001

WHEREAS you are intentionally evading service of summons it is hereby notified that if you shall not defend the case on the 28.10.2026 fixed for the final disposal, it will be heard and determined ex-parte.

Given under my hand and the seal of the court this 08.09.2026.

Senior Civil Judge-Cum-Rent Controller (North-West), District Court Rohini, Delhi

Seal of the Court

IN THE COURT OF SH. SIDHARTH MATHUR, District Judge-01 (North), Room Number 305, 3rd Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi
PC–21/23

SUNITA DEVI
–Petitioner
Versus
THE STATE AND ORS
–Respondents

PETITION UNDER SECTION 276 OF THE INDIAN SUCCESSION ACT FOR GRANT OF PROBATE WILL

WHEREAS an application under the Indian Succession Act, 1925 for grant of Probate of the Will or for Letters of Administration to the estate of LT. SH. NARESH KUMAR S/O OM PRAKASH DIED ON 15.01.2016, AT DELHI has been made by SUNITA DEVI W/O LT NARESH KUMAR R/O L-15/A, GALI NO 24, MAHINDRA PARK, AZADPUR, DELHI-110033.

Whereas the 11.02.2027 has been fixed for hearing of the case, notice is hereby given that person having any interest in the Administration of the Estate of the said concerned may if he/she desire appear in this Court of the said 11th DAY OF FEBRUARY 2027 see the proceeding before the grant of probate (or for letter of administration).

GIVEN under my hand and the seal of this Court on this 14-09-2026.

District Judge-01 (North), Rohini Courts, Delhi

Seal of the Court

IN THE COURT OF SH. SIDHARTH MATHUR, District Judge-01 (North), Room Number 305, 3rd Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi
PETITION U/S 7,8, & 10 OF THE GUARDIANSHIP AND WARDS ACT, 1890 FOR APPOINTMENT OF GUARDIAN OF PERSON AND PROPERTY OF THE MINORS
GP-8/26

BHAWANA
–PETITIONER
Vs.
THE STATE OF NCT OF DELHI
–DEFENDANTS

The petitioner (s) above named having applied to be adoption/appointed the guardian of the person and property of minor(s) / Lunacy MASTER KAIRAV SACHDEVA S/O LT. SH. SUNIL KUMAR R/O E-28, GROUND FLOOR DAIRY ROAD ADARSH NAGAR EXT. NEAR SHIV MANDIR DELHI-110033.

The 13.10.2026 have been fixed for hearing of the application and notice is hereby given to general public that if any other relatives/friends, kinsman or well wisher of the aforesaid minor/desire to adopt be appointed/declare as guardian of the person and property of the said minor/Lunacy of desire to oppose the application of the petitioner aforesaid he/she should enter appearance in persons in this court on the aforesaid date and be prepared to adduce on that day and documentary or oral evidence which he may desire to adduce in support of his/her claim to such adoption appointment of declaration of in support his/her opposition to the application of the petitioner aforesaid.

Given under my hand seal of this court on this the 21-09-2026.

District Judge-01 (North), Rohini Courts, Delhi

Seal of the Court

IN THE HIGH COURT OF DELHI AT NEW DELHI (ORDINARY ORIGINAL CIVIL JURISDICTION)
CS (OS) No. 690/2005

S. Harjit Singh & Anr
–Plaintiff
V/s.
S. Rawel Singh (Since Deceased) through LRs & Ors.
–Defendants
To
LRS OF DECEASED DEFENDANT NO. 2
(i) Sdn. Kulwant Kaur, W/o Late S. Daljeet Singh,
(ii) S. Manu Singh Sethi,
(iii) S. Chanchal Singh Sethi,
Both sons of S/o Late S. Daljeet Singh,
All R/o F-161, 2nd Floor, Mansarovar Garden, New Delhi-110015

WHEREAS the plaintiff above mentioned has instituted a SUIT FOR PARTITION AND PERMANENT INJUNCTION against you, the above named LRs of deceased defendant no. 2 and whereas it has been shown to the satisfaction of this Court that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way therefore, this notice is given by publication directing you, the above named LRs of deceased defendant no. 2 to make appearance before the Joint Registrar(Judicial) of this Court on 03.11.2026 at 11:00 AM.

Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before mentioned, the suit and IA will be heard and determined in your absence.

Given under my hand and the seal of this court in terms of order dated 07.09.2026.

Assistant Registrar(O)
for REGISTRAR GENERAL

Seal of the Court

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Chander Shekhar Chaturvedi S/o Late Badri Prasad R/o J-3/UG-5, Dilshad Colony, Delhi-110095 has severed relations and debarred my son Hari Shankar Chaturvedi and daughter-in-law Kritika alongwith his family from my movable-immovable properties due to their misconducts. I will not be responsible for their any acts.

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CM inaugurates command & control centre for integrated action against air pollution

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

SNS

CHIEF MINISTER REKHA GUPTA INAUGURATED THE INTEGRATED COMMAND AND CONTROL CENTRE (ICCC) AT THE DELHI METRO RAIL CORPORATION'S IT PARK AS PART OF THE ONGOING SEVA SANKALP ABHIYAN. THIS SPECIAL FACILITY WILL HELP IDENTIFY POLLUTION SOURCES AND PLAN COORDINATED ACTION.

To address the issue of air pollution in the national capital ahead of the winter season when the city grapples with severe air pollution every year, the Delhi government has taken an important step for source identification, analysis and inter-departmental coordination at a single platform.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated the Integrated Command and Control Centre (ICCC) at the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation's IT Park as part of the ongoing Seva Sankalp Abhiyan. This special facility will help identify pollution sources and plan coordinated action.

The ICCC is expected to strengthen the city's fight against air pollution through technology, data and faster action based on accurate and quick analysis.

The centre will enable real-time monitoring, pollution hotspot identification, data-driven analysis and inter-departmental coordination amongst different agencies concerned, and make things better.

CM Gupta shared that her government has been working to address the pollution issue ever since it assumed office. She called the ICCC another major step in this direction.

The facility will use AI-driven cameras to monitor the pollution situation.

Gupta said clean air in Delhi is a matter connected to the health of every family and the future of coming generations.

Her government is working 365 days 24×7 with complete force on every source of pollution.

The ICCC uses advanced technology, including AI analytics, to pinpoint the sources of pollution and the active hotspots that are the major contributors to the air pollution in city.

This time, the government is going to further tighten its noose on the non compliant vehicles, and those with invalid pollution control certificates will not be given fuel at the pumps across the city.

It is said that the command centre will also play crucial role as the nerve centre for all the tech-enabled measures like the Automatic Number Plate Recognition cameras (ANPR), that have been installed to identify non-compliant vehicles running on the roads.

The No PUC No fuel is more strictly going to be executed across the national capital.

Boost to sports infra in NW Delhi: LG inaugrates state-of-the-art DDA sports complex

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

In a major boost to modern sports infrastructure in North-West Delhi, Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Thursday inaugurated the Delhi Development Authority's sports complex at Sector-33, Rohini.

Spread over approximately 8.11 hectares, with a built-up area of approximately 10,974 square meters, the sports complex has been developed to bring quality sporting infrastructure closer to the residents of Rohini, Outer Delhi and adjoining areas of North-West Delhi.

Meanwhile, Sandhu also laid the foundation stone for an Electric Vehicle (EV) charging station in the vicinity of the sports complex.

He said he had an engaging interaction with budding players on the occasion encouraging them to pursue dreams with dedication, discipline and determination. "Under the guidance of PM Narendra Modi, we are harnessing the energy of our youth through sports and building world-class sporting infrastructure in Delhi. Train hard. Dream big. Strive for excellence," Sandhu stated.

At the inaugural ceremony, the LG announced the LG Cup for Hockey, to be held on October 9-18 with an aim to encourage and motivate young athletes and promote greater participation in team sports.

The ceremony was attended Delhi Minister Ravinder Indraj Singh, and Member of Parliament, Yogender Chandolia.

Later, the LG visited the DDA Aarambh Library in Rohini and interacted with students and had a positive and fruitful discussion with them on different topics. The students said they are enthusiastic about the facility and expressed happiness that it is helping them in shaping their future at such a nominal cost.

In view of a huge demand from the students for this library, the LG announced that the Rohini Library would be augmented by utilising one upper floor and creating more than 40 additional seats for the benefit of students.

DDA currently operates five Aarambh Libraries at Old Rajinder Nagar, Adhchini Village, Dwarka, Rohini and Vikaspuri, providing students with safe reading facilities at a very affordable cost.

The new Sports Complex has been developed with a combination of outdoor and indoor sports facilities. The outdoor facilities include 6 Lawn Tennis Synthetic Courts, 2 Basketball Synthetic Courts, 1 Netball Synthetic Court, 1 Volleyball Synthetic Court, a Skating Rink, Cricket Ground with natural turf, 2 Cricket Practice Nets with clay pitches, Football-cum-Hockey Ground with natural turf and a Jogging Track.

MCD to deploy 70 road-sweeping machines during winter to curb dust pollution

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

From mid-November, when winter pollution peaks in Delhi, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) will deploy 70 new mechanised road-sweeping machines (MSRM) across the city, according to an official statement.

The fleet, imported from Europe, comprises 55 electric and 15 CNG-powered machines. On Thursday, MCD Commissioner

Sanjeev Khirwar, inspected the field trials of new machines, the statement said. Delhi government airlifted the machines to Delhi for field trials using funds from the state Environment Department.

The self-propelled machines have sweeping capacities of 2 cubic metres and 4 cubic metres. MCD claimed that the imported machines equipped with an additional third front brush have improved sweeping efficiency and are more effective in dust and road debris removal.

Delhi's current MSRM count stands at 52, and collectively sweeps 1200 km of roads in the city. According to a recent study conducted by Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW), a Delhi-based Climate think tank, these machines together benefit only 18 per cent of the city's population.

The study highlighted that 42% of the existing coverage is concentrated in residential areas, while commercial zones, where higher traffic density contributes to greater dust resuspension, remain relatively underserved.

CM inaugurates Swachh Yamuna Prahari Campaign supported by BJP state unit

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

IANS

The Delhi government on Thursday launched the Swachh Yamuna Prahari Campaign. Inaugurated by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Delhi University's North Campus, the campaign is part of the government's efforts towards cleaning and conservation of the river, with the organisational support of the BJP's state unit.

Delhi BJP President Harsh Malhotra and Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh were present on the occasion, along with DU Vice Chancellor Yogesh Singh among others.

After the commencement of the campaign on Thursday, students from different colleges took a pledge to become Yamuna Praharis and contribute to the cleanliness campaign.

Gupta registered herself on the Swachh Yamuna Prahari App with a pledge to keep the Yamuna clean.

The Delhi government also launched a website, meriyamuna.in for people of Delhi to register themselves and become Swachh Yamuna Praharis.

Speaking on the occasion, Malhotra said over the past 12 years, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has not only spoken about development but also oversaw unprecedented development works in the country. Be it national highways, railway electrification, rural road scheme or several other initiatives, the PM has simultaneously given special attention to preserving and promoting India's culture, one of the world's oldest and richest.

Malhotra further said that Clean Ganga does not merely mean cleaning a river but India's life-giving rivers which are symbols of our culture. All rivers should be clean and pristine.

The Yamuna, after originating from Uttarakhand, passes through the plains of Haryana, Delhi and Uttar Pradesh before reaching the Triveni Sangam in Prayagraj.

Delhi air quality worsened in 2026, CAQM left out key average, claims report; Congress reacts

Delhi's air quality deteriorated during the first nine months of 2026 compared with the same period last year, while the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) left out the January-September average from its latest air-quality release, according to an analysis by Hawa Ka Hisab.

Citing the Central Pollution Control Board's (CPCB) daily 4 PM AQI bulletins, Hawa Ka Hisab said Delhi's average AQI between January and September 2026 was 167.6, compared with 164.3 during the corresponding period in 2025.

The analysis said the January-August average was also higher in 2026, at 175.7 against 171.7 in 2025.

According to Hawa Ka Hisab, CAQM did not publish a cumulative air-quality statistics release for any period between January and August 2026. Its latest release, issued on September 30, covered the January-September period. The analysis found that February, March, July and August 2026 recorded worse AQI averages than the corresponding months in 2025. July 2026 recorded an average AQI of 117.8, compared with 78.4 in July 2025, making it Delhi's worst July since 2019, based on CAQM's tables.

Hawa Ka Hisab also examined data from 39 monitoring stations that reported in both years. It said the AQI reached 500, the highest value on the scale, for 796 station-hours in 2026, compared with 256 station-hours in 2025. During those hours, PM2.5 reportedly averaged 439 micrograms per cubic metre, which Hawa Ka Hisab calculated was around 29 times the World Health Organization's 24-hour guideline.

Street Haul

Labourers push a handcart loaded with packaged goods past a mural of Lord Ram in New Delhi. SUBRATA DUTTA

Health Minister inspects Delhi State Health Mission, directs officials to plug gaps in programme implementation

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

Delhi Health Minister Dr Pankaj Kumar Singh on Thursday inspected the Delhi State Health Mission (DSHM) office and reviewed the implementation of various public health programmes, including TB elimination, dialysis, maternal and child health, immunisation, mental health, non-communicable diseases and disease surveillance.

During the visit, Singh interacted with doctors, technicians, programme officers and other staff and took stock of the functioning of different programmes and the requirements of healthcare personnel.

The Health Minister directed programme heads and senior officials to ensure close monitoring of implementation, timely resolution of operational gaps and effective coordination between field-level teams, healthcare institutions and senior officers.

"The Delhi State Health Mission is doing very good work for the people of Delhi. During my visit, I interacted with our doctors, technicians and other staff and enquired about their work and requirements. I have directed the concerned officials and programme heads to ensure that all programmes are being implemented properly and that any gaps are addressed without delay," Singh said.

He stressed that healthcare personnel should receive the necessary facilities and support on time to enable them to discharge their duties effectively.

"Healthcare personnel must also receive the facilities and support they require to perform their duties effectively," the minister said.

The DSHM oversees and coordinates several major health initiatives, including TB elimination, disease surveillance, maternal and child health, immunisation, adolescent health, family planning, anaemia control, vector-borne disease control, mental health, non-communicable diseases, dialysis, tobacco control, leprosy, blindness control and oral health.

MoD organises voluntary blood donation camp on National Voluntary Blood Donation Day

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

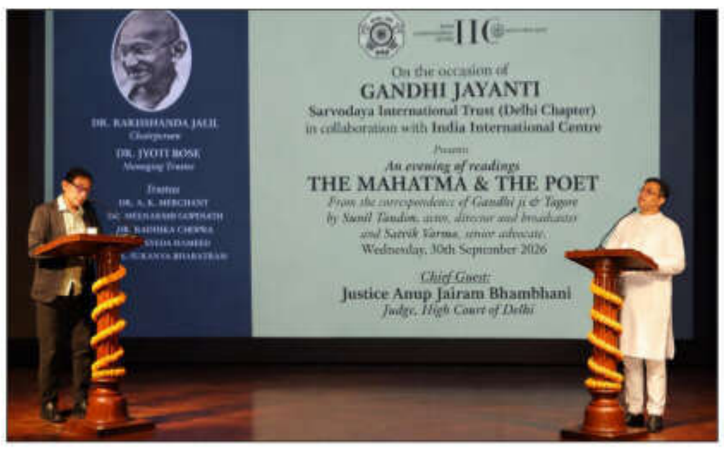
The Ministry of Defence, in collaboration with the Armed Forces Transfusion Centre, organised a voluntary blood donation camp at Kartavya Bhavan-2 here on Thursday on the occasion of National Voluntary Blood Donation Day. The theme of this year's campaign was "One Drop of Humanity, Give Blood, Save Lives." The blood donation drive was conducted under the supervision of a dedicated medical team comprising two Medical Officers, two Junior Commissioned Officers and 10 paramedical staff, including Blood Transfusion Assistants. Necessary medical equipment and facilities were made available at the camp.

A total of 134 officers and officials of the Ministry of Defence participated in the blood donation drive. Before donating blood, all participants underwent counselling and health screening to ensure their safety and compliance with prescribed medical standards.

Chief of Defence Staff and Secretary, Department of Military Affairs, General N S Raja Subramani, Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, Secretary, Department of Ex-Servicemen Welfare Sukriti Likhi, besides senior officers and officials of the Ministry of Defence, participated in the camp and donated blood. The initiative highlighted the importance of voluntary blood donation and sought to encourage greater participation in efforts aimed at saving lives and ensuring the availability of safe blood for patients in need.

The Mahatma & The Poet: Healthy debate and criticism bedrocks of democracy

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October



HE UNDERLINED THE IMPORTANCE OF PLURALISM AND OPEN DIALOGUE IN TODAY'S WORLD, REMINDING THE AUDIENCE THAT HEALTHY DEBATE AND CRITICISM ARE THE BEDROCKS OF DEMOCRACY.

Paying a rich tributes to the Father of the Nation on the eve of Gandhi Jayanti, the Delhi Chapter of the Sarvodaya International Trust, along with India International Centre, held a special evening, "The Mahatma & the Poet," featuring readings from the historic correspondence between Mahatma Gandhi and Rabindranath Tagore.

Notably, Mahatma Gandhi's granddaughter, Mrs. Tara Bhattacharya, grandson Gopal Gandhi, and other family members were present on the occasion.

Addressing the gathering, Justice Anup Jairam Bhambhani, Delhi High Court of Delhi judge and the chief guest at the event, emphasized that the communication between Mahatma Gandhi and Rabindranath Tagore stands as a timeless model for constructive disagreement.

He underlined the importance of pluralism and open dialogue in today's world, reminding the audience that healthy debate and criticism are the bedrocks of democracy.

Dr. Rakhshanda Jalil, Chairperson of the Sarvodaya International Trust, New Delhi chapter welcomed the gathering of the Trustees of the SIT and eminent personalities from the field of education, science, and also Gandhians.

The soul-stirring readings, "The Mahatma & the Poet," presented by Sunit Tandon and Satvik Varma, showed how the two great men could deeply disagree yet engage with one another with warmth, reason and reverence.

The interplay of Gandhi's political and ethical vision with Tagore's humanistic and universal outlook made the presentation thought provoking and deeply relevant to the contemporary times.

Dr. Jyoti Bose, Managing Trustee, SIT, while proposing the vote of thanks, highlighted that the exchanges between the two great personalities reflected their intellectual and respectful dissent while retaining deep affection for each other, which is the need of today's times.

The Statesman
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Journalism's test

The crisis facing journalism is often described as a crisis of business, technology or public trust. It is all three. But beneath them lies a more consequential question: what happens to a democratic society when reliable journalism ceases to be a viable institution? The digital revolution has already dismantled the old information hierarchy. Newspapers and broadcasters once decided what entered the public conversation. Today, a post on X, a YouTube video, a WhatsApp message or an AI-generated answer can reach millions before a newsroom has finished checking the facts. This is where the importance of journalism has to be reconsidered. Its essential function was never simply to deliver news. Distribution is now something technology companies can do at enormous scale. Journalism matters because someone must establish what happened, distinguish evidence from assertion, expose wrongdoing, provide context and hold powerful institutions to account. That work is expensive. Investigations take time. Reporters have to cultivate sources, verify documents, travel, obtain records and withstand pressure from governments, corporations and political interests. None of this becomes cheaper merely because an audience can receive a news alert free of charge.

The economic consequences are therefore inseparable from the democratic ones. If advertising migrates to technology platforms while audiences expect news to cost nothing, newsrooms inevitably shrink. The first casualties are likely to be precisely those forms of journalism whose social value is greatest but whose immediate commercial return is weakest: local reporting, specialised reporting, investigative work and sustained coverage of institutions that do not generate clicks.

Yet journalism cannot respond to this crisis simply by demanding that audiences trust it. Trust is earned through performance. Established media have made errors, displayed biases and sometimes allowed political or commercial interests to influence coverage. These failures cannot be dismissed merely because social media is worse. The credibility of journalism depends on transparency, corrections, rigorous sourcing and a visible separation between reporting and advocacy. Nor can cooperation among media organisations alone solve the problem.

Collaboration may help newsrooms share costs, technology and investigative resources, but institutional survival is not the same as public legitimacy. Journalism has to adapt to the ways people now discover information without surrendering the standards that make journalism different from information circulating on the internet. Artificial intelligence makes this distinction even more important. If machines can instantly produce plausible explanations, summaries and narratives, the scarce commodity will increasingly be verified knowledge rather than words. News organisations that merely reproduce information will find themselves competing with machines.

Those that possess original reporting, authoritative sources and institutional credibility will have something much harder to replicate. The message of World News Day, observed on September 28, is therefore timely: the future of journalism depends not on preserving its old forms, but on proving that its essential functions remain indispensable. A society cannot easily function without institutions capable of establishing facts and scrutinising power. The future of journalism will ultimately depend not on preserving its old forms, but on proving that those functions remain indispensable.

Chilling Effect

Maharashtra's new anti-conversion law raises a question considerably larger than whether the State should prevent people from being coerced into changing their religion. No democratic society should permit conversion through force, fraud or intimidation. The more difficult question is what happens when legislation designed to prevent such abuse begins to make legitimate religious activity itself appear legally hazardous.

The most revealing sign is not a prosecution but a precaution. Some churches around Mumbai have begun asking worshippers to sign declarations that they attended voluntarily and were neither forced nor induced to come. Such declarations have no official legal standing. Yet their emergence tells us something important about the atmosphere created by the new law: religious institutions are beginning to prepare evidence of innocence before an accusation has even been made.

That is not a trivial administrative adjustment. It represents a shift in the relationship between the citizen and the State. Prayer is ordinarily a private exercise of conscience. A voluntary gathering for worship should not require participants to establish, on paper, that they exercised their own free will. If churches feel compelled to maintain such records because a prayer meeting might subsequently be portrayed as an attempted conversion, the law is producing a chilling effect beyond the conduct it was ostensibly designed to regulate.

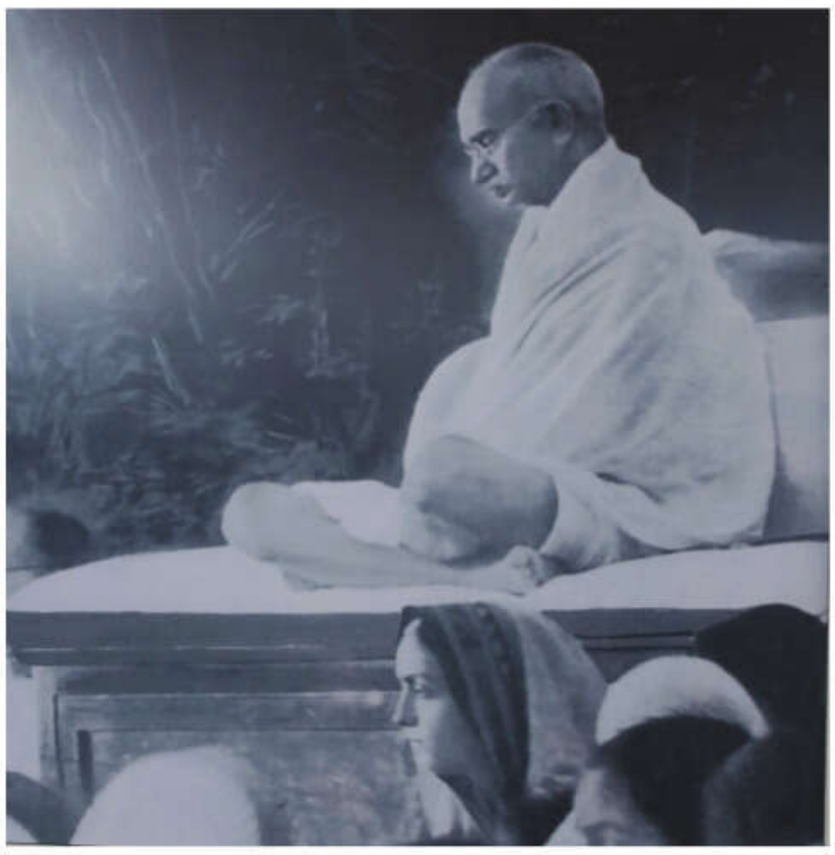
The problem is sharpened by the breadth of the legislation. Concepts such as inducement can encompass employment, education, marriage, promises of an improved life and claims of divine healing. These matters can arise naturally in the activities of religious and charitable organisations. Without carefully defined boundaries, conduct that one person regards as religious persuasion or social assistance can become the basis of an allegation by another.

The complaint mechanism also deserves scrutiny. Allowing relatives to approach the police over an alleged unlawful conversion may protect vulnerable people in genuine cases. But it can equally bring family disputes, community pressure and ideological hostility into matters of personal conscience. Interfaith couples could be particularly exposed, even when neither partner intends to convert. The State has a legitimate interest in protecting citizens from coercion. But that interest must be balanced against another constitutional principle: an adult's freedom to determine what to believe, whom to worship and whether to change religion. The burden of preventing coercion should not quietly become a burden on citizens to demonstrate that their religious choices are innocent.

Maharashtra's experience will therefore test more than the effectiveness of an anti-conversion statute. It will test whether the law can distinguish between coercion and persuasion, between exploitation and voluntary assistance, and ultimately between a genuine public wrong and an individual's exercise of conscience. A law intended to protect freedom should not create a situation in which people feel obliged to carry paperwork proving that they are free.

Message of Asia

'So far as I can see, the atomic bomb has deadened the finest feeling that has sustained mankind for ages. There used to be the so-called laws of war which made it tolerable. Now we know the naked truth. War knows no law except that of might. The atom bomb brought an empty victory to the Allied arms, but it resulted for the time being in destroying the soul of Japan'



"What I want you to understand is the message of Asia. It is not to be learnt through the Western spectacles or by imitating the atom bomb. If you want to give a message to the West, it must be the message of love and the message of truth," wrote Mahatma Gandhi in Harijan on 20 April 1947. "In this age of democracy, in this age of awakening of the poorest of the poor, you can redeliver this message with the greatest emphasis. You will complete the conquest of the West not through vengeance because you have been exploited, but with real understanding...The West today is pining for wisdom. It is despairing of a multiplication of the atom bombs, because atom bomb means utter destruction not merely of the West but of the whole world, as if the prophecy of the Bible is going to be fulfilled and there is to be a prefect deluge. It is up to you to tell the world of its wickedness and sin-that is the heritage your teachers and my teachers have taught Asia."

The Mahatma was categorical that "the weapon of violence, even if it is the atom bomb, becomes useless when it is matched against true non-violence."

When the Mahatma was writing the 'message of Asia' the sub-continent was in the throes of great turmoil, political and social. Horrific communal violence in 1946 had seared the provinces, especially Bengal and Bihar. By February 1947 Prime Minister Clement Attlee made the dramatic announcement that the British would withdraw from India not later than June 1948. Attlee also announced that the Viceroy Lord Wavell would be replaced by Lord Louis Mountbatten.

Unsparing in his criticism of the Western powers after World War II, Gandhiji wrote, "I regard the employment of the atom bomb for the wholesale destruction of men, women and children as the most diabolical use of science." He questioned the wanton ruthless violence: "What is the antidote? Has it antiquated non-violence? No. On the contrary, non-violence is the only thing that is now left in the field. It is the only thing that the atom bomb cannot destroy. I did not move a muscle when I first heard that the atom bomb had wiped out Hiroshima. On the contrary, I said to myself, 'unless now the world adopts non-violence, it will spell certain suicide for mankind.'"

From the pages of Harijan (September 1946), these words are prophetic, underlining the Mahatma's understanding of world history as it was unfolding. "I have no doubt, that unless big nations shed their desire of exploitation and the spirit of violence of which war is the natural expression and atom bomb the inevitable consequence, there is no hope for peace in the world. I tried to speak out during the War and wrote open letters to the British people, to Hitler and to the Japanese and was dubbed a fifth columnist for my pains."

In post-World War 20th century and now in the 21st century, wars and incessant bombings, and the use of chemical weapons have become part of diplomatic-military manoeuvres of the West. Prolonged wars in Korea, Vietnam, Cambodia, Afghanistan, the Gulf region, Syria, Iraq, Crimea, Ukraine, Gaza and Israel-Iran have scarred the countries. This is a horrific roll-call of the brutal massacre of millions and destruction of ancient lands by imperialist powers about whom Gandhi had been warning, year after year.

Writing in Harijan on 7 September 1946, the Mahatma was relentless in rallying against the atom bomb and highlighting Ahimsa or non-violence. "It has been suggested by American friends that the atom bomb will bring in Ahimsa (non-violence) as nothing else can. It will, if it is meant that its destructive power will so disgust the world that it will turn it away from violence for the time being. This is very like a man glutting himself with dainties to the point of nausea and turning away from them only to return with redoubled zeal after the effect of nausea is well over. Precisely in the same manner will the world return to violence with renewed zeal after the effect of disgust is worn out," he prophesied.

"Often does good come out of evil. But that is God's not man's plan. Man knows that only evil can come out of evil, as good out of good. That atomic energy, though harnessed by American scientists and army men for destructive purposes, may be utilized by other scientists for humanitarian purposes, is undoubtedly within the realm of possibility. But that is not what was meant by my American friends. They were not so simple as to put a question which connoted an obvious truth. An incendiary uses fire for his destructive and nefarious purpose, a housewife makes daily use of it in preparing nourishing food for mankind," he argued.

RAJU MANSUKHANI

The writer is a researcher-author on history and heritage issues, and a former deputy curator of Pradhanmantri Sangrahalaya

Once again the Mahatma's grasp on global politics is apparent. He could see how the Western powers were trapped in the spiral of violence. "So far as I can see, the atomic bomb has deadened the finest feeling that has sustained mankind for ages. There used to be the so-called laws of war which made it tolerable. Now we know the naked truth. War knows no law except that of might. The atom bomb brought an empty victory to the Allied arms, but it resulted for the time being in destroying the soul of Japan. What has happened to the soul of the destroying nation is yet too early to see. Forces of nature act in a mysterious manner. We can but solve the mystery by deducing the unknown result from the known results of similar events. A slave-holder cannot hold a slave without putting himself or his deputy in the cage holding the slave. Let no one run away with the idea that I wish to put in a defence of Japanese misdeeds in pursuance of Japan's unworthy ambition. The difference was only one of degree. I assume that Japan's greed was more unworthy. But the greater unworthiness conferred no right on the less unworthy of destroying without mercy men, women and children of Japan in a particular area," he wrote with candour and characteristic fearlessness.

Where does the violence and counter-violence lead? "The moral to be legitimately drawn from the supreme tragedy of the bomb is that it will not be destroyed by counter-bomb, even as violence cannot be by counter-violence. Mankind has to get out of violence only through non-violence. Hatred can be overcome only by love, Counter-hatred only increases the surface as well as the depth of hatred. I am aware that I am repeating what I have many times stated before and practiced to the best of my ability and capacity. What I first stated was itself nothing new. It is as old as the hills. Only, I recited no copy book maxim, but definitely announced what I believe in every fibre of my being. Sixty years of practice in various walks of life has only enriched the belief which the experience of friends has fortified. It is, however, the central truth by which one can stand alone without flinching. I believe in what Max Muller said years ago, namely, that truth needed to be repeated as long as there were men who disbelieved it," he explained.

The Mahatma could sense and feel the greed of the powerful when he wrote: "The very frightfulness of the atom bomb will not force non-violence on the world? If all nations are armed with the atom bomb, they will refrain from using it as it will mean absolute destruction for all concerned? I am of the opinion that it will not. The violent man's eye would be lit up with the prospect of the much greater amount of destruction and death which he could now wreak."

Earlier in Young India on 13 September 1928, Gandhiji had enunciated the meaning and purpose of non-violence. "For me non-violence is not a mere philosophical principle. It is the rule and the breath of my life. I know I fail often, sometimes consciously, more often unconsciously. It is a matter not of the intellect but of the heart. True guidance comes by the constant waiting upon God, by utmost humility, self-abnegation, by being ever ready to sacrifice one's self. Its practice requires fearlessness and courage of the highest order. I am painfully aware of my failings," he wrote.

"But the light within me is steady and clear. There is no escape for any of us save through truth and non-violence. I know that war is wrong, is an unmitigated evil. I know too that it has got to go. I firmly believe that freedom won through bloodshed or fraud is no freedom... Not violence, not untruth, but non-violence, Truth is the law of our being," wrote the Mahatma whose birth anniversary on 2 October is commemorated as Gandhi Jayanti every year.

THE KATHMANDU POST

Are Nepali schools ready for the AI takeover?

Have you ever imagined a class run by robots, where artificial intelligence (AI) delivers teaching and learning? And if that day comes, how would anyone assess what is taught and what is learned?

My own question began when I caught a student relying entirely on ChatGPT to finish an assignment. Prompt engineering has reshaped the world, yet many schools, colleges and universities still hold firmly to pen and paper. Technology is neither a blessing nor a curse. What matters is how we use it, and increasingly it shapes how we live. Among secondary school students, AI use is spreading fast. Very few remain outside its grip when an assignment is due. Young learners today have little appetite for sitting with a problem for an hour until it yields. I see their creativity thinning, and their patience with it.

Nepal's National AI Policy 2025 marks a milestone. It opens the way for AI education in the school curriculum in the coming years. Meanwhile, AI has already moved beyond the brick-and-mortar classroom into the digital one. It is hard to find a student who has never used it or knows nothing about it.

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I will concede that the use of AI has real merits. It sharpens students' ability to search for information and gives them new ways to learn and present ideas. A short, clear answer arrives in seconds and spares them hours of reading through books. It can also shape its response as a chart, a figure or a graph, in whatever language the request was made.

The trouble begins with how it is used. AI answers what you ask. It has no sense of your level or how you learn. The most visible problem is copied assignments, but the deeper one is students trading their study time for screen time and ending up with almost nothing in their heads. Copying an answer without grasping a single line of the concept leaves a kind of brain fog, marked by weak focus, mental confusion and poor memory. Classroom engagement has fallen sharply, since an answer is always a few seconds away. Students sit in the room but are absent from the lesson. The screen has cost their health as well. Few in my class arrive properly rested. Patience is shorter now, and I see more anxiety, sudden flares of temper, headaches and memory complaints. These are the young people who will one day lead the government and steer the economy, and they will do it with AI in hand. Then comes the ethical dilemma. Which answer is the honest one: the one drawn from books and the student's own language, or the one generated by AI, when the substance of both is much the same? The consequences surface quietly in the examination hall, where students who have only ever copied are left with nothing to write and fail.

The government has directed schools to use AI in teaching and learning through its AI policy, but it offers no clear plan for implementing it or for evaluating students. That gap at the centre widens as AI users multiply in every classroom. Parents cannot tell whether their children are on track. The assignments are complete, and attendance is regular, yet examination scores are poor. Some begin to wonder whether the teacher is teaching well at all.

Letters To The Editor

editor@thestatesman.com

National song

Sir, The BJP government's emphasis on the National Song, *Vande Mataram*, and its insistence that the song be sung in its entirety at public gatherings, raises legitimate questions. While *Vande Mataram* undoubtedly occupies an important place in India's freedom struggle and deserves respect, compelling citizens to sing portions that contain religious references could conflict with India's constitutional commitment to freedom of conscience and religious belief.

The Supreme Court's decision in Bijoe Emmanuel v. State of Kerala (1986) is relevant in this context. The Court held that students who respectfully stood during the National Anthem but did not sing it could not be compelled to do so when their objection was based on genuine conscientious belief. The judgment affirmed that freedom of conscience and religion under Article 25 cannot be curtailed because an individual declines to participate in a particular form of patriotic expression. Against this constitutional and historical background, any attempt to compel citizens to sing all the stanzas of *Vande Mataram* deserves scrutiny.

Patriotism cannot be measured by one's willingness to participate in a prescribed form of expression. Respect for the nation must coexist with respect for freedom of conscience, religious diversity and the constitutional principle of unity in diversity.

Yours, etc., Tharcius S. Fernando,
Chennai, 27 September.

Credibility

Sir, This refers to your well-written editorial "Umpire on trial" published on 27 September which rightly draws attention to the most important issue confronting the Election Commission today - not merely its legal authority, but public confidence in its independence and impartiality.

The editorial's comparison of the Commission with an umpire is pertinent. An umpire must not only be impartial but must also command the confidence of both sides. In the same way, the credibility of an electoral institution depends on how its independence is secured, perceived and demonstrated.

I would add that institutional credibility is built over many years but can be weakened quickly when questions concerning electoral rolls, voter-data management or internal decision-making remain insufficiently explained.

The Commission should, therefore, adopt maximum transparency in such matters and clearly explain the safeguards governing its procedures. Internal differences, wherever they arise, should also be dealt with through established institutional mechanisms rather than leaving room for speculation.

Similarly, political parties should ensure that criticism of the Commission is based on verifiable facts rather than mere allegations. The Commission, for its part, must respond to legitimate questions with facts, clarity and transparency.

Ultimately, the issue surpasses any individual office-holder or political party. The credibility of the Election Commission is inseparable from that of the electoral process itself.

An institution entrusted with conducting the people's mandate must inspire confidence not merely by asking citizens to trust it, but by demonstrating why that trust is justified.

Yours, etc., Amit Kanti Jana,
Kolkata, 28 September.

Gandhi's ideas have found expression under Modi

TUHIN A. SINHA

Mahatma Gandhi's contribution to India was not confined to winning freedom from colonial rule. He also left behind a powerful social and economic vision of the India that freedom ought to create: a clean India, self-reliant villages, economic dignity for the poorest, empowerment of tribal communities and a society free from intoxicants. Twelve years of the Modi era offer a fascinating story of how several of these distinctly Gandhian ideals have been translated into contemporary public policy-and, importantly, measured at population scale.

The most striking example is Swachh Bharat. Gandhi considered sanitation not a peripheral concern but a civilisational imperative. His famous formulation that cleanliness is next to godliness captured a larger belief: a free India had to be a dignified India, and dignity began with the most basic surroundings in which people lived. When Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the Swachh Bharat Mission on 2 October 2014, rural sanitation coverage stood at just 39 per cent. By October 2019, it had reached 100 per cent, with more than 10 crore individual household toilets constructed and all villages declaring themselves Open Defecation Free. The mission has subsequently moved from toilet access to sustainability, waste management and ODF Plus villages.

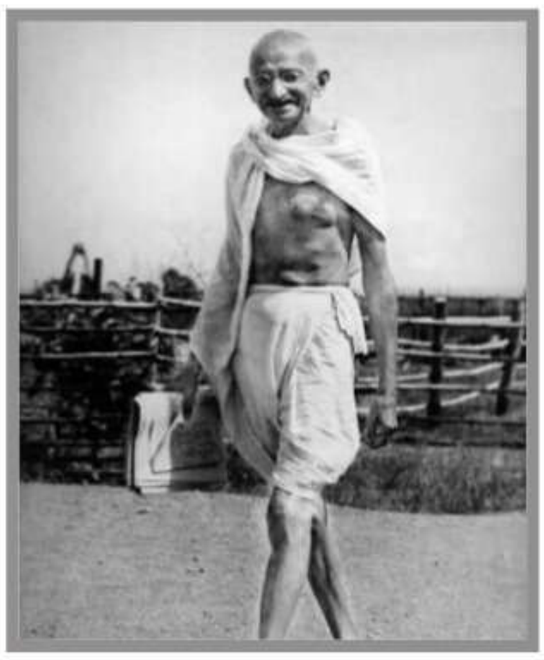
The significance goes beyond the numbers. Swachh Bharat converted sanitation from a government department's responsibility into a mass behavioural movement. It made cleanliness a matter of citizenship and collective pride. In doing so, an idea Gandhi had preached became a national habit that the state attempted to institutionalise.

The same transformation is visible in Gandhi's idea of Swadeshi and village industries. For Gandhi, khadi was never merely fabric. It represented self-reliance, productive work, dignity of labour and the economic empowerment of villages. The revival of Khadi and Village Industries under the Modi government provides unusually tangible evidence of this philosophy acquiring a modern economic life.

According to provisional KVIC data, sales of Khadi and Village Industry products rose from Rs 31,154 crore in 2013-14 to Rs 1.87 lakh crore in 2025-26, a 501 per cent increase. Employment in the sector has risen by 56 per cent over the same period to 2.04 crore people. The language has changed from Gandhi's Swadeshi to today's Vocal for Local, Local to Global and Aatmanirbhar Bharat. But the underlying proposition remains recognisable: India's villages should not merely consume wealth generated elsewhere; they should produce, create and prosper themselves.

Gandhi's concern with economic equality finds another contemporary expression in financial inclusion. His Constructive Programme explicitly placed economic equality among the foundations of a just society. The Modi government's Jan Dhan architecture has sought to give that ideal an institutional foundation.

In August 2014, formal banking access remained out of reach for millions. Twelve years later, PM Jan Dhan Yojana has crossed 59 crore accounts, with deposits of Rs 3.17 lakh crore. More than 56 per cent of account holders are women and nearly 78 per cent of accounts are in rural and semi-urban areas. Over 41 crore RuPay cards have been issued.



The deeper change is not the number of bank accounts. It is the shift from exclusion to economic agency. Through the Jan-Dhan-Aadhaar-Mobile architecture, welfare payments and other financial services can reach beneficiaries directly. A poor citizen with a bank account, digital identity and access to formal financial services occupies a very different economic position from one dependent upon intermediaries. Gandhi's vision also included the empowerment of Adivasis, whom he regarded as an integral part of India's social fabric. Here too, the emphasis under Modi has increasingly moved beyond welfare towards livelihoods and entrepreneurship.

The Pradhan Mantri Janjatiya Vikas Mission has sanctioned 4,172 Van Dhan Vikas Kendras, linking 12.48 lakh tribal members to enterprises built around value addition to minor forest produce. These centres provide support for training, processing, packaging, branding and market access. By July 2026, 2,911 of these centres were functional, with reported sales of around Rs 168 crore.

The philosophical shift is important. Instead of seeing tribal communities only as beneficiaries of development, the model seeks to position them as producers, entrepreneurs and owners of economic value chains. That resonates strongly with Gandhi's insistence on dignity, self-reliance and empowerment at the grassroots.

And then there is Gram Swaraj. Gandhi did not romanticise a village of deprivation. His ideal village was clean, productive, connected to essential services and capable of providing its people with dignity and opportunity. Modern technology has allowed this ideal to be pursued in ways Gandhi could never have imagined.

Jal Jeevan Mission is a powerful illustration. When it began in 2019, only 3.24 crore rural households - 16.72 per cent - had tap-water connections. By July 2026, the figure had reached 15.89 crore households, or 82.09 per cent.

Add rural roads, housing, electrification and digital connectivity, and the village is no longer being treated as the geographical opposite of modernity. The objective is to bring modern infrastructure to the village while strengthening community participation in its management. That is a contemporary interpretation of Gram Swaraj: not isolation from the world, but empowerment within it.

The final Gandhian ideal is Nashamukti, and here intellectual honesty requires a different formulation. Gandhi was a passionate opponent of intoxicants and included prohibition in his Constructive Programme. The Modi government's Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan is an unmistakable continuation of that social objective, but a Drug-Free India remains a work in progress, not a completed achievement.

Launched in 2020, the campaign has expanded into a nationwide movement involving awareness, prevention, treatment, rehabilitation and community participation. By July 2026, it had reached more than 29.32 crore citizens, including 11.20 crore youth and 7.92 crore women, while more than 21 lakh awareness activities had been conducted in educational institutions.

That distinction matters. The story of the past twelve years is not that every Gandhian aspiration has been completed. It is that several of Gandhi's core ideas have moved decisively from the realm of moral exhortation into measurable public policy.

Swachhata, Swadeshi, economic dignity, tribal empowerment, Gram Swaraj and Nashamukti were not merely Gandhi's slogans. They were his blueprint for a stronger India. The Modi era has sought to give that blueprint a 21st-century institutional and technological form - taking ideas born in the freedom struggle and attempting to make them realities for hundreds of millions of Indians.

The writer is a national spokesperson, BJP and accomplished author.

A costly way of raising forex

BISHWAJIT BHATTACHARYYA

India's forex (foreign exchange) reserves have always oscillated between tolerable and uncomfortable. After 1976-77 India's foreign trade (merchandise) balance has always been negative; India's dependence on import of crude oil adds to the discomfiture.

With a view to insulate India from the vicissitudes of war, Reserve Bank of India conceived an expensive scheme to garner a substantial slice of additional forex with effect from 8 June 2026, by wooing Non-Resident Indians (NRIs). NRIs lapped up the opportunity. $127.2 billion flowed in swiftly to the FCNR (Foreign Currency Non-Resident) "B" deposit scheme of the RBI. India's foreign exchange (forex) reserves swelled to a record high of $740.8 billion as on 31 August 2026.

FCNR-B deposits were so lucrative that the RBI had to close the scheme prematurely on 31 August 2026, instead of on 30 September 2026; otherwise, India would have been further flooded with costly unstable funds, as argued hereinafter.

A salient feature of the FCNR-B scheme is that entire funds with interest are freely repatriable abroad. Secondly, the funds are immune from currency risks, which means, every dollar shall be repaid only in dollar, regardless of the dollar's exchange rate prevailing on the date when the NRI receives the funds abroad.

The RBI bears the exchange risk, estimated at 3 per cent per annum. The cost for raising $127.2 billion for 5 years (maximum) is an estimated $19.08 billion. This is a direct fiscal hit on India, with annual cost exceeding a hefty $3.8 billion. Add to it the interest burden on banks, and servicing cost. The funds move out of India in the end.

Thirdly, the funds with interest accrued, are entirely tax free in India.

urthly, NRIs were allowed to leverage funds up to "19 times the deposit amount", as reported in the Times of India on 3 September. The report states: "The borrowed funds could then be placed as FCNR (B) deposits, allowing the borrowers to earn a spread of 1 per cent between their borrowing cost and the return on deposits."

This means, against FCNR-B deposits in India (for example @5 per cent interest), funds can be borrowed abroad (for example @4 per cent interest), which can be further channelled into another fresh FCNR-B deposit in India earning for example 5 per cent interest.

The process can keep multiplying. This is called leveraging. In every round of leverage, the NRI earns a return of 1 per cent, which is also known as arbitrage profit. It's money for jam. Borrow at a lower cost abroad, deposit them with a higher yield in India, and pocket the difference.

Fifthly, FCNR-B deposits offered a high rate of interest in dollars, in some cases exceeding 7 per cent.

To explain the mechanism of leveraging, assume an NRI in Singapore (SG) remits from his account with Citi Bank SG, a sum of $100,000, to his account with Bank "A" in Delhi, towards FCNR-B deposits, yielding interest @ 5 per cent.

At this point leveraging commences. Bank "A" in Delhi marks a lien, on FCNR-B deposits of $100,000, in favour of Citi Bank SG. Against this lien in favour of Citi Bank SG, the NRI borrows $100,000 from Citi Bank SG, with an interest liability @ 4 per cent.

With funds so borrowed from Citi Bank SG, the NRI remits a further sum of $100,000 to Bank "A" in Delhi into the corpus of his FCNR-B deposits.

If this exercise is carried out 19 times, then FCNR-B deposits will become $2 million, earning interest

@ 5 per cent in Bank "A" in Delhi and the NRI's loan account will show a debit balance of $1,900,000 in Citi Bank SG, incurring a liability of interest @ 4 per cent.

The NRI's yearly earning at a 1 per cent interest profit on $1.9 million will be $19,000. After five years this will become $95,000, which will be his tax-free profit in India in 5 years.

If the NRI's initial FCNR-B deposit is $1 million, then after five years his total tax free profit in India will be $950,000.

And the NRI's initial savings will continue to earn tax free interest in Bank "A" in Delhi.

Exactly, the same yield can be worked out, by directly borrowing $1.9 million in Singapore and depositing $2 million (the borrowed sum plus savings of $100,000) in Delhi. There was no upper limit of FCNR-B. Little wonder that $127.2 billion came in swiftly.

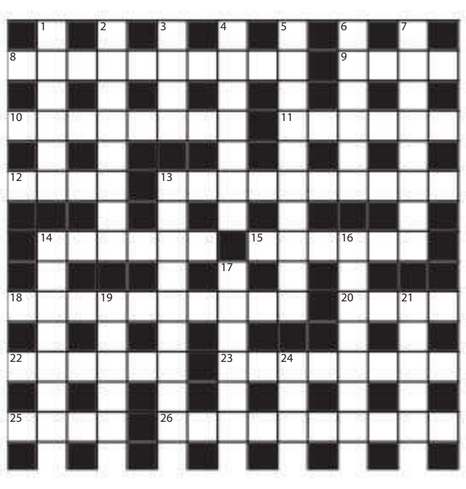
Thus, FCNR-B scheme 2026 attracted only hot, unstable and costly funds. This was not necessary, since India already had about $650 billion of forex reserves.

In emergent situations, softer institutional borrowings should be preferred to such unstable costly funds as FCNR-B.

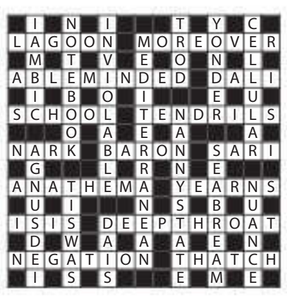
India's finances deserve responsible handling.

The writer is Senior Advocate, Supreme Court, and ex Additional Solicitor General of India.

Crossword | No. 293597



Yesterday's Solution



ACROSS

8 Spoils trouser fabric, introducing drop of antique liqueur (10)
9 Man's sound? It must be the armour (4)
10 Change brings in tenor in excellent piece by Gilbert and Sullivan (8)
11 Left it in care of former editor (6)
12 Sudden attack has one leaving Italian city (4)
13 Delay with sheep jumping? One doesn't need jumping sheep (10)
14 British attracted to authentic German playwright (6)
15 Police appearing after travel document trimmed? That's sticky (6)
18 Expert on Muslim leader brought into court (10)
20 No expression of contentment from boat-builder (4)
22 White companions deserted force in conflicts (6)
23 It helps one remember being churlish about Caesar's opening comment (8)
25 End of forest area stripped by fire, ultimately – ash? (4)
26 I will participate in request, not against making a start (10)

DOWN

1 Middle of exam, and confused over capital of Uruguay – an exotic place (6)
2 Discrepancy, note, in serving of caviare (8)
3 Significant figure seen in piece of currency I promoted (4)
4 Soccer team players are in Paris? I questioned commitment (7)
5 Cricketer initially cross about beer, having received nothing (5,5)
6 I'm a derogatory comment as intended by a prankster? (6)
7 Source of red and white? Red and navy, I fancy (8)
13 Regarding education, second option (dropping English) will receive stick (10)
14 Intellectual work degraded during economic success (8)
16 Notice FT is torn up, producing bits of paper (8)
17 Was a number of ships required? Try I saw three ships, perhaps (7)
19 Long document beginning to support belief system (6)
21 American writer revealing name of apostle forgotten in Bible (6)
24 University to veto operating system (4)

NOTE: Figures in parentheses denote the number of letters in the words required. (By arrangement with **The Independent, London**)

100 Years Ago

Front page of The Statesman dated 02 October 1926

OCCASIONAL NOTE

Returns for the week ended September 18 show that 798 deaths were registered in Calcutta during that time, giving a mortality rate of 38.6 per thousand. Excluding "imported" deaths, the rate for the town itself was almost identical with that for the suburbs—37.2 in one case and 37.4 in the other. Calcutta not having been afflicted by any epidemic, the figures, which are largely in excess of the average for the province —29.6, according to the latest available statistics—need interpretation. They hardly consist with the supposedly greater healthfulness of the metropolis. Presumably the imported cases are more numerous than the returns suggest.

News Items

TORTURE OF PUBLICITY

PRINCE OF WALES LIMITS PUBLIC DINNERS

(From Our Special Representative.)
London, Sept.

Mr. A. G. Gardiner, in an article in the Star, says that the Prince of Wales's limitation of public dinners is the first sign of a rebellious spirit and should command public approval, because the infinite vista of banquets must be simply terrifying to the Prince who is the greatest living victim of the torture of publicity. Everywhere he is pursued by the limelight and camera until his heart must ache for the quiet seclusion enjoyed by ordinary mortals. He is unable to buy a hat without attracting as much attention as if he were a giraffe. It is a hard life despite the foolish belief that it is an enviable one. The cruellest fact is that it is a sentence for life.

RELIEF OF WUCHANG

FRENCH AND U. S. SHIPS COMMANDEERED

Shanghai, Sept.

A message from Hankow says it is reported that troops of Sun Chuanfang Tuchun of Kiangsu, are approaching to the relief of Wuchang. French and American steamers have been commandeered to bring troops down the river from the Upper Yangtse. —Reuter.

CHEMIST'S ERROR

HAPPY ENDING TO RADIO HUNT FOR CUSTOMER

London, Sept.

There has been a happy ending to the wireless search for Mr. Penn, who was given by a Birmingham chemist pills which contained one-fourth of a grain of strychnine instead of one-fortieth of a grain. This afternoon the purchaser of the pills telegraphed to the chemist from London, where he read of the mistake in a newspaper, that none of the pills had yet been taken. The announcement has greatly relieved the chemist, who upon the discovery of his error, telegraphed a warning to every Penn in the directory.—Reuter.

HOARDED COINS

CONTINUED RUSH TO SELL TO BANK

Paris, Sept.

The reappearance of the item in the Banque de France's balance sheet, "Gold and Silver Coins Bought," showing 6,000,000 francs purchased in Paris alone, substantially reflects the scenes outside the bank of daily lengthening queues exchanging hoarded coins. The greatly augmented bank staff is so busy counting long-unseen cash that numerous gold bearers have to be turned away every night. A similar rush in the provinces has, in some cases, necessitated extra police to control the queues.—Reuter.

BRIEFLY

DYFI activists attack Kerala minister's vehicle in Kannur:

Kannur: Kerala Minister and Youth Congress state president O J Janeesh's official vehicle was allegedly attacked by DYFI activists at multiple places in Kannur district on Thursday, shortly after DYFI leader and MLA M Vijin allegedly warned that the organisation would confront the issue on the streets.

The incident occurred as Janeesh was travelling to Kasaragod after attending an official Archaeology Department programme in Kannur.

The first incident occurred at Kuppam in Taliparamba, where DYFI activists allegedly stopped the vehicle and attacked it with stones and their hands, damaging its flag pole and rain guard. Police and security personnel accompanying the minister intervened to remove the protesters.

The vehicle faced protests at several other locations on its way through Kannur, with alleged attacks reported at five places, including Taliparamba and Payyannur.

Stones were hurled at the car soon after it crossed Payyannur, damaging other parts of the vehicle.

POCSO case accused Veeramani, two aides detained under Goondas Act

UNITED NEWS OF INDIA
Chennai, 1 October

Paedophile accused and Granite-baron R Veeramani, and two of his aides, who were arrested under POCSO Act were on Thursday detained under the Goondas Act.

While the tainted bizman was arrested on charges of sexually assaulting several juvenile girls over the years, two of his acquaintances Shanthi and her husband Mahendra Simkan, were arrested on charges of abetment and all the three were detained under the Goondas Act.

The orders detaining the trio under the Goondas Act was issued by Greater Chennai City Police Commissioner A Amalraj following which he was formally detained at the Puzhal Central prison, where they were lodged under judicial remand.

As per the provisions of Goondas Act, the accused could not get bail for one year from the date of detention and could get relief only through the court.

The Commissioner also ordered detention of 11 other arrested accused, who were facing various criminal charges, under the Goondas Act, a release from the police commissioner's office said.

Veeramani was arrested on 29 August after the POCSO court rejected the closure report and ordered to probe the matter based on the FIR registered in October 2025. Cases were registered against Veeramani and others under Secs 7,8,15(1), and 21(1) of the POCSO Act, Sections 354(A), 354(C), 201, and 120(B) of IPC and Sections 66(E), and 67(B) of the IT Act.

Police have so far arrested four people, including the tainted businessman, his acquaintance Shanthi and her husband Mahendra Simkan and Veeramani's long time former staffer Ganesan, from whom police have recovered videos puroportedly containing the inappropriate acts of the industrialist. He was arrested for not sharing the videos to the investigating authorities and also to ascertain the source from which he had received it.

All the four were in judicial remand and the High Court has reserved its orders on the bail plea of the arrested couple. As the probe by

the CCB police unravelled several startling revelations including huge money trial running to crores of rupees and the involvement of

top police officials and also some affluent and influential persons, the Tamil Nadu Government constituted an all-women Special Investigation Team (SIT) which has now taken up the investigation.

In a latest update on the probe, police today evening said so far four POCSO cases were registered against Veeramani and was booked

for abetting the suicide of a minor, who was also subjected to sexual assault by the industrialist, ten years back.

'Cash-for-votes' charge haunts TVK as Left joins Oppn chorus

MC RAJAN
Chennai, 1 October

A 'cash for votes' allegation is haunting the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), which prides itself as a 'clean force'. The allegation is being raised in the bypoll for two assembly constituencies not only by the opposition DMK and AIADMK but also by the two Left parties, which extend crucial outside support to the minority Vijay government.

Allegations are flying thick and fast since the 6 October bypoll for Madurantakam and Dharapuram is seen as a barometer of the five-month-old government's performance and Vijay's charisma. Despite supporting the government, the CPI and CPI-M have entered the fray, maintaining that they are neither part of the TVK-led alliance nor of the opposition DMK-led combine. They are contesting one seat each.

"While Chief Minister Vijay maintains that the TVK is a force of purity and won't indulge in bribing voters with cash, it is the TVK which is the highest bidder by paying more. People in Madurantakam are saying this," CPI-M state secretary P Shanmugam told reporters on Thursday, after leading a demonstration seeking the ouster of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, who is facing 'vote chori' charges.

"Yesterday, we were distributing pamphlets in Madurantakam, and people told us, 'You are giving only notices, but everybody is giving money'. When asked who all are giving cash, they said, 'The TVK is giving more than others. You too give us some', Shanmugam said, and demanded that the TVK leadership should respond to this.

The AIADMK was the first to lodge a complaint against the TVK with Tamil Nadu Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Archana Patnaik last week itself. Party leader IS Inbadurai, MP, filed the complaint urging the poll panel to deploy more forces to prevent the ruling party from bribing voters.

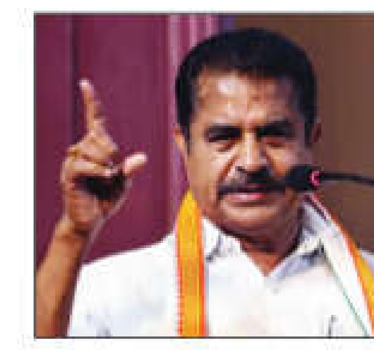
Turning the tables on the opposition, the TVK had also approached the CEO to stop the DMK from distributing cash to voters, citing the seizure of Rs 40 lakh from a DMK functionary's residence in bypoll-bound Dharapuram.

Meanwhile, Vijay, who addressed a handful of rallies for the assembly election, is forced to sweat it out in the bypoll. Having addressed two campaign rallies ~ one each in Madurantakam and Dharapuram ~ he is visiting Madurantakam tomorrow with a roadshow at 39 places. Keen on winning the two seats, the TVK had appointed poll in-charge ministers to coordinate the poll strategy and door-to-door canvassing.

The bypoll is necessitated by the resignation of AIADMK legislators, Maragatham Kumaravel (Madurantakam) and P Sasthyabama (Dharapuram), within 20 days of their election, and their joining the TVK. Vijay has rewarded both with re-nomination, inviting the charge that the TVK is actively indulging in horse trading.

Adoor Prakash criticises CM Satheesan over stalled UDF meetings and lack of consultation

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Thiruvananthapuram, 1 October



United Democratic Front (UDF) convener and Congress MP Adoor Prakash publicly criticised Kerala Chief Minister V D Satheesan for operating unilaterally and bypassing internal coalition consultations on key administrative decisions.

Speaking to the media here, Adoor Prakash stated that he frequently learns of major government actions and appointments through media reports rather than formal front-level discussions.

The UDF convener expressed strong dissatisfaction with the lack of coordination within the UDF, noting that official front meetings have stalled because the Chief Minister, who serves as chairman, has failed to decide on convening them. While the convener holds the responsibility to call the state committee, doing so requires the chairman's permission. Prakash stated he should not have to constantly remind the Chief Minister of his duties, urging for a swift resolution.

He revealed that the absence of internal consultations left him unable to clearly answer media queries regarding the UDF, a situation he deeply regretted. While clarifying that he did not oppose decisions like granting cabinet status to Dr M K Muneer, calling it well-deserved, Prakash voiced his frustration at being kept in the dark despite his role as convener, leaving it to the media to judge if he was being intentionally sidelined.

He added that since the AICC appointed him, he would report these front-level matters to the high command as needed. Furthermore, he attributed the UDF's mixed performance in the local body by-elections ~ where they managed to win 18 seats but fell short in expected wards ~ to a severe lack of coordination, demanding that the leadership proactively address and resolve internal differences.

Karnataka CM seeks action over alleged pre-filled Form 7 voter deletions

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Bengaluru, 1 October

Karnataka Chief Minister D K Shivakumar and his Cabinet colleagues on Thursday submitted a representation to State Chief Electoral Officer Anbukumar, urging him to register a case against those allegedly involved in a conspiracy to delete genuine voters belonging to minority communities, Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and Other Backward Classes from the electoral rolls through pre-filled Form 7 applications.

Shivakumar visited the office of the State Election Commission in Gandhinagar, Bengaluru, and submitted the representation to Anbukumar.

Shivakumar alleged that pre-filled details were being used through Form 7 to seek the deletion of names of legitimate voters belonging to minority communities, Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and Other Backward Classes from the electoral rolls. He urged the Chief Electoral Officer to initiate legal action and register cases against those involved in the alleged conspiracy.

KPCC President B K Hariprasad, Ministers Priyank Kharge, S S Mallikarjun, Eshwar Khandre and M B Patil, BDA chairman N A Haris, former Legislative Council Chairman V R Sudarshan and others were present on the occasion.

In his letter to CEO Anbukumar, Shivakumar stated, "As the Chief Minister of Karnataka it is my bounden duty to protect the rights of every eligible voter in a state and to ensure that the electoral revision process is conducted in a free, fair, transparent and legally compliant manner. No eligible citizen, irrespective of religion, caste, community or social background, should be deprived of the right to remain on the electoral roll."

"I am given to understand that a large number of Form 7 objections seeking deletion of names from the electoral rolls have been filed in bulk, particularly during the last few days of the claims and objections period, including on 22nd, 23rd and 24th September." "The scale and manner of the filings are a matter of serious concern. For instance, it has been reported that approximately 3,000 Form 7 applications were filed in Belgavi North Assembly Constituency, 6,259 in Mudigere Constituency, 1,373 in Babaleshwar Constituency, 1,200 in Narasimha Raj Constituency and 2,285 in Bhalki Constituency, besides a similarly large number in other constituencies."

The representation highlighted several concerns over the filing of Form 7 applications seeking deletion of voters from electoral rolls. It stated that a large number of Form 7 applications appeared to have been filed in bulk within a short period, particularly during the final days of the prescribed period. It also alleged that a disproportionate number of voters proposed for deletion belonged to minority communities, Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and Other Backward Classes, warranting immediate verification. The representation further pointed out that in several cases, voters' names, EPIC numbers and other particulars appeared to have been pre-printed on Form 7 applications, with only the objector's details subsequently filled in. It sought an enquiry into how such electoral data was accessed and used.

It also sought verification of cases involving individuals filing unusually large numbers of objections and their reported political affiliations.

The representation referred to public statements allegedly made by defeated BJP candidate Ravi B. Patil regarding Form 7 applications filed through his associates and sought collection and examination of relevant applications and video footage.

TENDER

राजस्थान टूरिज्म डवलपमेंट कॉरपोरेशन लिमिटेड
(राजस्थान सरकार का उपक्रम) पर्यटन भवन, तृतीय तल, विधायकपुरी थाने के सामने, एम. आई. रोड, जयपुर-302001, फोन : 91-141-2361140, 2371141-42 : Email: croho@rtdc.in
क्रमांक :- 2442 दिनांक :- 29/09/2026
ई-निविदा सूचना सं. 09/2026-27
राजस्थान पर्यटन विकास निगम लि. जयपुर की ओर से राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र सरकार के विभागों एवं सार्वजनिक उपक्रमों में उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से 'Online NIB' आमंत्रित की जाती है। इन कार्यों की अनुमानित लागत, निविदा बेचे जाने व प्राप्त करने की दिनांक, निविदा शर्तें आदि संपूर्ण विवरण वेबसाइट www.rtdc.tourism.rajasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in & sppp.rajasthan.gov.in पर देखी जा सकती है।
UBN No. : TDC2627SLOB00080
राज.संवाद/सी/26/11104 निदेशक - तकनीकी

राजस्थान टूरिज्म डवलपमेंट कॉरपोरेशन लिमिटेड
(राजस्थान सरकार का उपक्रम) पर्यटन भवन, तृतीय तल, विधायकपुरी थाने के सामने, एम. आई. रोड, जयपुर-302001, फोन : 91-141-2361140, 2371141-42 : Email: croho@rtdc.in
क्रमांक :- 2439 दिनांक :- 28/09/2026
ई-निविदा सूचना सं. 08/2026-27
राजस्थान पर्यटन विकास निगम लि. जयपुर की ओर से राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र सरकार के विभागों एवं सार्वजनिक उपक्रमों में उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से 'Online NIB' आमंत्रित की जाती है। इन कार्यों की अनुमानित लागत, निविदा बेचे जाने व प्राप्त करने की दिनांक, निविदा शर्तें आदि संपूर्ण विवरण वेबसाइट www.rtdc.tourism.rajasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in & sppp.rajasthan.gov.in पर देखी जा सकती है।
UBN No. : TDC2627WSOB00077, 00078, 00079
राज.संवाद/सी/26/11103 निदेशक - तकनीकी

DELHI TRANSCO LIMITED
EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)
DTL intends to invite following Expression Of Interest (EOI):
Inviting stakeholder inputs and feedback to validate and strengthen the bidding process for establishing public EV charging and battery swapping infrastructure under the Delhi EV Policy, 2026.
For complete details of EOI please visit website: - **https://dtl.gov.in.**
Inputs may be submitted within 07 days of this publishing through:
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSdWs_QD5i3Kh3fUL4idBlSyNy4Y03j9-eNIIWusz2ZIQJjfpg/viewform?pli=1&pli=1.

Any stakeholder / individuals willing to offer land parcels, parking areas or premises for the establishment of EV charging or battery swapping stations may furnish site details via:
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSddpitB_62KBFaJh8iZpY9fOx8sBepLCH8Y7euKB_DiP4rFAw/viewform?usp=preview.

राजस्थान स्कूल शिक्षा परिषद्
[illegible]
फोन नं. 0141-2700459, E-Mail- RAJSMSA.CIVIL@RAJASTHAN.GOV.IN
क्रमांक :- F-5(1)(325)RCSCE/Civil/NIT 2026-27 /2026/D-4046 दिनांक :- 29/09/2026
CORRIGENDUM
अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 12 (सिविल)/2026-27
राज्य परियोजना निदेशक, समग्र शिक्षा एवं आयुक्त स्कूल शिक्षा, राजस्थान की ओर से राज्य एवं केन्द्र सरकार के राजकीय/अर्द्धशासकीय/स्वायत्तशासी निकायों में सक्षम श्रेणी में निर्माण कार्यों हेतु पंजीकृत संवेदकों से समग्र शिक्षा वार्षिक कार्य योजना एवं बजट वर्ष 2021–2022, 2022–23, 2023–24, 2024–25, 2025–26, 2025–26 (Supplementary), राज्य मद 2025–26, लेखानुदान की बजट घोषणा वर्ष 2024–25 (Phase-I, II, III, IV, V, VI, VII) एवं पी.एम.श्री. वर्ष 2025–26, नाबार्ड RIDF XXVIII, डी.एम.एफ.टी, एम.एल.ए. लेड, इत्यादि योजनान्तर्गत स्वीकृत 167 राजकीय विद्यालय/केजीबीवी में डाईनिंग हॉल के निर्माण/मरम्मत कार्यों हेतु ई–निविदा सूचना सं. 12 (सिविल)/2026–27 का प्रकाषन करवाया गया था। जिसमें निम्नानुसार संशोधन है:–
निविदा की अन्य शर्तें यथावत रहेगी।

क्र.	प्रकाशित निविदा के अनुसार	संशोधन उपरांत निम्नानुसार पढ़ा जावे
1	क्र सं. 15 पर विद्यालय का नाम GUPS KRISHAN NAGAR KALAN एवं यू–डाईस कोड 8150119901 के स्थान पर।	विद्यालय का नाम GOVT. UPPER PRIMARY SCHOOL KALYAN SINGH KI SIDD एवं यू–डाईस कोड 8150104804 पढ़ा जावें।
2	उक्त प्रकाशित ई निविदा में निविदा प्रपत्र डाउनलोड करने की अंतिम दिनांक 04.10.2026 को सायं 06.00 बजे एवं निविदा खोले जाने की दिनांक 05.10.2026 को अपरान्ह 2.00 बजे थी।	उक्त ई निविदा में संशोधन उपरांत निविदा प्रपत्र डाउनलोड करने की अंतिम दिनांक 06.10.2026 को सायं 06.00 बजे तक एवं निविदा खोले जाने की दिनांक 07.10.2026 को अपरान्ह 2.00 बजे एवं तक पढ़ा जावें।

UBN NO.- RSE2627WSOB01381
राज.संवाद/सी/26/11097 राज्य परियोजना निदेशक समग्र शिक्षा

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice NO. 46/2026-2027 Dated: 30.09.2026
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	14260913A	RUBBER BASED ADHESIVE	51151 LTR	22.10.26
02	09262541	CROSS BAR	4090 NOS	26.10.26
03	07261530	AIR BRAKE HOSE COUPLING	28862 NOS	26.10.26
04	15245210C	HIGH SPEED PRECISION LATHE MACHINE	2 NOS	28.10.26
05	16265043	SPRING SINGLE COIL	264 NOS	29.10.26
06	16265042	NICKLE CADMIMUM BATTERY	7 SET	02.11.26

NOTE- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.
3404/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Procurement Tender Notice No.: 26/46 Date: 29.09.2026
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
On behalf of the President of India, **The Principal Chief Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj, (An ISO 9001:2015 certified unit)** invites the following E-procurement Tenders.

S. N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Tender Opening Date
1	30262027	SECONDARY SPRING (OUTER) FOR GENERATOR CAR SIDE-2	220 Nos.	20.10.2026
2	64265114A	Squeezing Cylinder	288 Nos.	02.11.2026

Note: The complete information of above tenders can be seen and downloaded from **IREPS** website i.e. **https://www.ireps.gov.in.** For any change/corrigendum in tender, please visit this website regularly. No separate corrigendum/change will be published in news paper.
2220/26 (A)
North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

TPWODL
TP WESTERN ODISHA DISTRIBUTION LIMITED
(A Joint Venture of Tata Power and Government of Odisha)
Corporate Office : Burla, Dist.-Sambalpur (Odisha)-768017
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
T.No.TPWODL/RK/O/SU/2500001290 Date: 30.09.2026
TP Western Odisha Distribution Limited, invites tender quotations (in 2part bidding) from eligible vendors for the following package :
PO for Supply of SMC LT Distribution Box at TPWODL, Odisha.
Interested bidders are to submit Tender Participation Fee and Authorization Letter through email on or before **6th October 2026, 15:00Hrs** after which the link from e-Tender system shall be shared with them.
For detailed tender documents of the above-mentioned tender, please visit Tender section of **www.tpwesternodisha.com.** All details for participating in tender is given in the tender document.
All future correspondence regarding the tender, bid submission, date extension etc. will take place with the participating bidders only through E-Tender system.
Sd/- **Head- Contracts & Procurement**

TPWODL
TP WESTERN ODISHA DISTRIBUTION LIMITED
(A Joint Venture of Tata Power and Government of Odisha)
Corporate Office : Burla, Dist.-Sambalpur (Odisha)-768017
Corrigendum-I to Notice Inviting Tender (NIT)
T.N No. TPWODL/HS/O/SU/2500001286 Date: 21-09-2026
Extension of due date for payment of Tender Fee towards purchase of Tender Documents and Revised Calendar events.
Following amendments to the subject tender be noted by the bidders: **TPWODL/HS/O/SU/2500001286** for Supply of Smartphone, Speaker, Neck Band Earphone and Smart Watches at TPWODL.
1. Clause 1.3: Revised Calendar of Events shall be as mentioned below:

Sr No	Calendar of Events	Existing Schedule	Revised Schedule
1	Last date and time of Payment of Tender Fee	28.09.2026 1700 Hours	05.10.2026 1700 Hours
2	Last Date of receipt of pre-bid Queries if any	30.09.2026 1700 Hours	07.10.2026 1700 Hours
3	Last Date of Posting Consolidated replies to all the pre-bid queries as received	03.10.2026 1700 Hours	10.10.2026 1700 Hours
4	Last date and time of receipt of Bids	28.09.2026 1700 Hours	14.10.2026 1700 Hours

All other terms and conditions of the above tender will remain same.
Sd/- **Head-Contracts and Procurement**

CENTRAL RAILWAY
NAGPUR DIVISION
E-TENDER NOTICE
OPEN TENDER NOTICE No. DRMWNGP-97-2026 OF 29/09/2026
1) Name of work: Proposal for hiring of companion for the patrolling duty as companion to main patrolman in section under ADEN Betul and ADEN Amla sub-division. **(i) Approximate cost:** Rs. 12249856.32, **(ii) Earnest Money:** Rs. 245000.00, **2) Name of work:** USFD Testing of AT welds manually by hand probing in midterm of frequency reflected in TMS for three year., **(i) Approximate cost:** Rs. 5129400.00, **(ii) Earnest Money:** Rs. 102600.00, Date & time of closing of tender 21/10/2026 15:00 Hrs. Complete details and instructions for e-tendering and on-line participation for the above work is available on Railway's website **www.ireps.gov.in**
Divisional Railway Manager (Works) Nagpur
444
Traveling with dangerous and explosive goods is a punishable offense

RAIPUR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Bhakta Mata Karma Complex, New Rajendra Nagar, RAIPUR (Chhattisgarh) 492006
Website : https://rdaraipur.cgstate.gov.in/, Email : ceordaryp@gmail.com, Fax : 0771-2536188
NIT No. 25 **Notice Inviting Tender** Dated : 30.09.2026
Online Bids are invited for the following of works upto **12.10.2026 at 5:30 PM**

Sr. No.	System Tender No.	Name of work/Description of work	Type of Contract	Tender Amount	EMD Amount	Time Period	Tender Fee+ Processing Fee
1	200657	Balance Strengthening and Renovation Work of Block-D at Adarsh Bazar Scheme of Raipur Development Authority, Including Construction of Toilets, Waterproofing of All Blocks and Allied Civil Works **(2nd Call)**	Percentage Rate Basis in "Form-A"	Rs. 51,34,000/- (Excl. GST)	Rs. 61,000/-	04 Months from reckoned date	Rs.10,000/- including GST+ Rs. 311/- (Non Refundable) to be paid online

The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh e-procurement portal **https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in.** More details of the tender and bidding process may be obtained from the above-mentioned portal.
NOTE : (1) All eligible/interested contractors are mandated to get enrolled on e-procurement portal. **(2)** Contractors can contact help desk for any clarification of their doubt regarding the process of electronic procurement system. Help Desk at Toll Free No. 1800-233-7188 or through Email ID **ceordaryp@gmail.com, cerdaryp@gmail.com,** Website : **https://rdaraipur.cgstate.gov.in (3)** For more details, please download NIT details.
Executive Engineer

BRIEFLY

Woman death row inmate survives execution attempt in Tennessee:

Nashville: Tennessee officials were unable to put Christa Gail Pike to death Wednesday for a 1995 murder after administering two doses of a lethal drug. A death penalty expert said it was an unprecedented failure, and Tennessee Gov Bill Lee halted the one remaining execution for the rest of the year.

Pike, 50, was alive and loudly snoring after the attempted lethal injection and taken by ambulance from the prison, her attorneys said. She was being treated at a hospital, but they said they hadn't been told about her condition.

She had been scheduled for execution at 10 a.m. Wednesday for the killing she committed at age 18 and would have been the first woman executed in Tennessee in more than 200 years. An appeals court stopped the lethal injection just an hour before it was to start and hours later the US Supreme Court overturned that stay. Officials gave Pike two doses of pentobarbital, her attorneys said in court filings late Wednesday. Gov Bill Lee said in a statement that he has ordered "a comprehensive, third-party review to determine exactly what occurred" and that the remaining scheduled execution will not take place this year.

"Carrying out a lawfully imposed sentence is among the State's most serious responsibilities, and the people of Tennessee expect it to be done in a manner that is not only legal and constitutional, but is effective," he said.

S Korean President vows to ease military tensions with N Korea:

Seoul: South Korean President Lee Jae Myung on Thursday pledged to persistently seek practical ways to reduce military tensions with North Korea, even as the two Koreas are at odds over the recent blast of North Korean mines along the border. The president made the remarks on North Korea at a ceremony marking the 78th Armed Forces Day at the military headquarters in Gyeryongdae, South Chungcheong Province, following last week's explosions of two North Korean mines in the Demilitarised Zone (DMZ) that left three South Korean soldiers wounded.

"My administration will consistently pursue practical measures to reduce military tensions between the two Koreas," Lee said, *Yonhap News Agency* reported.

"The knots in inter-Korean relations are extremely complex, but we will steadily, patiently strive to untie them, one by one," the president said.

He said peace and prosperity must be forged with "our own hands," and that "the surest form of security is one that renders conflict unnecessary, in other words, one that creates peace." "For the sake of peace on the Korean Peninsula, the two Koreas must find a way to win together and build trust," the president said, adding that building trust "begins to take root, little by little, when words are matched by actions."

He also invited North Korea to join Seoul on "the path of restoring trust and resuming dialogue." Lee's message came a day after the South Korean military announced that the DMZ blast caused by mines planted by North Korean mines constitutes a "blatant violation" of the armistice agreement that ended the 1950-53 Korean War and demanded an apology and responsible measures from Pyongyang.

Attacker's motive remains unknown after FlyDubai flight to Israel escapes disaster

AGENCIES
Jerusalem, 1 October

The motive of the Omani copilot who stabbed his captain on a flight to Israel, causing the plane to plummet dangerously and forcing it to land in Saudi Arabia, remained unknown on Thursday as investigators across the region raced to learn more.

Israeli passengers who were on the FlyDubai aircraft carrying 174 people from the United Arab Emirates to Tel Aviv have described how the bloodied Indian captain managed to open the cockpit door to let them in before they grappled with the copilot and stabilised a descent so sharp that the plane's rudder was torn away.

"We felt helpless, suspended in midair, and I didn't know who to turn to. But it was all instinct to survive," one of the responders, Asaf Rajuan, said in a new statement shared by Israel's presidency.

A regional official briefed on the investigation said the suspect, an Omani citizen, was under arrest and confirmed that Saudi authorities were working with countries, including Israel, to try to determine a motive. He said the UAE, the United States and Oman also were involved. The official did not describe the extent of Israeli involvement.

"All possible scenarios, from terrorism to mental disorders, are being looked into. Nothing is ruled out for now," said the official, speaking on condition of anonymity to discuss the probe. Israeli intelligence and security officials were investigating the copilot in Saudi Arabia, according to another regional official who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorised to speak to the media.

Saudi Arabia does not have formal diplomatic ties with Israel, but there is longstanding security and intelligence cooperation through alternative channels.

Video shot inside the plane by Shota Musayev, a dentist who treated the captain, shows the copilot on his knees, with his hands tied behind his back. The copilot's name still has not been released.

The UAE government said its investigation team had begun its work into the motive and "whether it was linked to any terrorist purpose," adding that UAE law applies to crimes committed on board.

Capt. Smit Machchhar, widely praised as one of the heroes of the flight, was reportedly in stable condition, the Indian Embassy in Saudi Arabia said overnight. The condition of the copilot was not clear.

Asked if there is any indication of Iranian involvement, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu told *Fox News* "it's too early to say." The prime minister told *CNN* that Israel had received no specific warning.

US President Donald Trump told reporters at the White House that he and Netanyahu discussed the incident "at length" by phone and it seemed as though the copilot "was perhaps a terrorist or perhaps a whack job."

Netanyahu said he also spoke with the UAE's president, Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, who agreed that Israel would join the interrogation of the suspect.

Kabul says Pakistani airstrikes in Afghanistan kill 10 civilians

AGENCIES
Kabul, 1 October

Pakistan carried out airstrikes in two Afghan provinces overnight, both countries said Thursday, with Afghanistan saying 10 civilians were killed, mostly women and children, and that at least 10 were wounded in the bombings.

Pakistan's Ministry of Information said its strikes were against militant hideouts in two locations and that initial reports suggested 22 militants had been killed. The casualty claims from either side could not be independently verified.

The strikes come amid repeated cross-border clashes between the two countries, while Pakistan has repeatedly carried out airstrikes inside Afghanistan since tensions between the two countries spiraled dramatically earlier this year. The two neighbours have longstanding disputes over militant activity along their border.

The United Nations Mission in Afghanistan said last week that it had documented over 1,100 civilian deaths and injuries in Afghanistan from cross-border violence so far this year. Pakistan denies striking civilians, and says it targets militants who carry out attacks inside Pakistan. Afghanistan denies harboring militants.

The spokesperson for Afghanistan's Taliban government, Zabihullah Mujahid, said the airstrikes hit civilian homes in southern Helmand province and the eastern province of Kunar, destroying three houses.

Hegseth announces a new drone command and cuts to 20 per cent of generals in 'State of the Force' speech

AGENCIES
Quantico, 1 October

Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth announced some major changes to the US military on Wednesday in what he called his "State of the Force" address, including establishing a new drone command and cutting 20 per cent of the nation's generals and admirals.

The Pentagon also will launch an effort to study the future of warfare that will be led in part by SpaceX CEO Elon Musk and former Republican House Speaker Newt Gingrich, Hegseth said. The Defence Department will create an Office of Religious Affairs and plans to build a new base for the first time in 40 years, he added.

Hegseth made the announcements to junior officers and enlisted leaders at the Marine Corps Base Quantico in Virginia ~ the second year in a row that he has given such an address. But this time, the US military is seven months into a war with Iran with no clear end in sight, has captured Venezuelan leader Nicolás Maduro and killed more than 200 people in strikes on alleged drug trafficking boats in Latin America, among other actions worldwide.

The speech is not a usual fixture among Pentagon leaders. While Hegseth's predecessors have regularly addressed troops and top officers, they have traditionally done so in small or private settings.

The Pentagon chief, however, again led with how he has drastically retooled the US military by targeting what he calls "woke" culture ~ through a rollback of diversity programs, a review of ground combat units with female troops and a new screening programme for "testosterone deficiency" among male personnel ~ as well as attacks on the media for the coverage of the military.

The Pentagon chief announced the intention to create a new four-star command to oversee the rollout of autonomous and robotic capabilities in what he called "the fastest peacetime shift in modern military history."

Jet-powered drones outpace Ukrainian defences as manufacturers race to build new interceptors

AGENCIES
Kyiv, 1 October

Russia's new class of jet-powered drones rip across the night sky in Kyiv at hundreds of kilometers per hour, leaving Ukrainian air-defence units only moments to intercept them. It's rarely enough time.

With many of the drones getting through to the capital, defence manufacturers are scrambling to develop a new generation of interceptors to counter the deadly threat. They are building their own jet-propulsion systems and training artificial intelligence to help guide the chase.

They need to move fast because the Russian drones are driving a new tactic, ramped up in recent weeks, to hit the infrastructure keeping Ukraine's war-battered economy afloat. Recent targets have included energy systems, key industries, railways, post offices, shopping centres, telecom networks, gas

stations and grain exports.

Russia also has an advantage with its ballistic missile arsenal, which poses another challenge as Ukraine runs low on interceptor missiles.

The effects of the barrage are being felt in Kyiv, which increasingly resembles a front-line city, without the relative safety that had long set it apart from the fighting. Food supplies have been disrupted, explosions echo day and night, and residents scramble for cover from strikes that reach closer to the city centre. Ukrainian officials say they are testing new interceptors that have successfully hit jet-powered Russian drones, which fly much higher and faster than propeller-driven drones and are much harder to stop.

"They're moving so fast that we can't get a proper lock on them," said Volodymyr Serdiuk, commander of an air-defence unit. Building the prototype interceptors in sufficient numbers, and training pilots to fly them, could take up to six months, manufacturers say. President Volodymyr Zelenskyy has called for faster production.

UK tells academics to cut ties with Chinese institute that MI5 brands a front for spying

AGENCIES
London, 1 October

The British government on Wednesday told UK universities to stop working with a Chinese research institute that Britain's security service says is a front for espionage.

Security Minister Dan Jarvis said British academics should "end all arrangements" with the China General Technology Research Institute.

A spokesperson for China's Embassy in the UK vehemently denied the accusations, calling them "imaginary and purely fabricated."

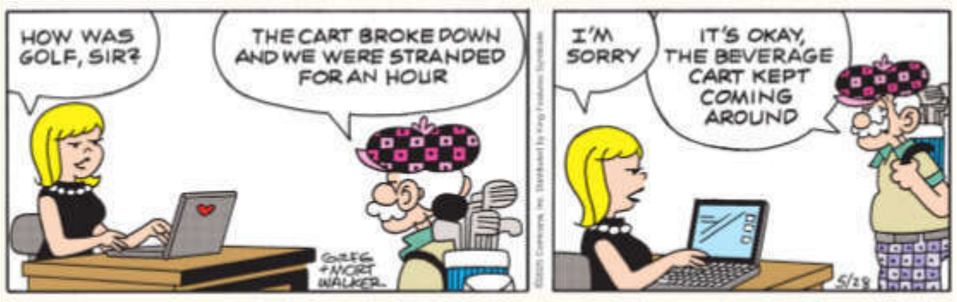
"We firmly oppose such baseless allegations and have lodged solemn representations with the UK side," the spokesperson said in a statement.

MI5, Britain's domestic intelligence agency, said more than 100 UK-linked academics have worked on projects secretly funded by Chinese intelligence through the research institute. The projects included work on cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, covert communications systems and steganography, the practice of hiding messages. MI5 said the institute has "very strong ties to the Chinese Ministry of State Security" and seeks to fund research that improves the Chinese state's "technical capacity for espionage."

British intelligence officials have in recent years steadily ramped up their warnings about espionage threats from China, the UK's third largest trading partner.

LEISURE

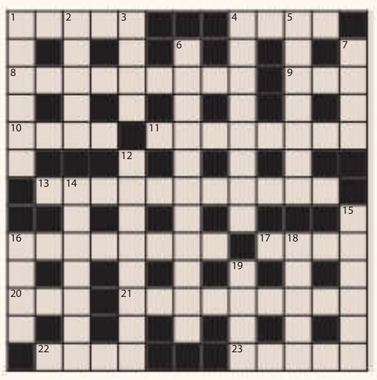
BEETLE BAILEY



TIGER

DADDY DAZE

10 MINIUTE CROSSWORD



ACROSS

1 Deciduous tree (5)
4 Wail (4)
8 Tropical fruit (9)
9 Mineral spring (3)
10 Slender (4)
11 Inclination (8)
13 Insolent (11)
16 Unmarried man (8)
17 Threesome (4)
20 Female pronoun (3)
21 Type of actor (9)
22 Small duck (4)
23 Oneness (5)

DOWN

1 Type of road (6)
2 Boredom (5)
3 Be told (4)
4 Refinement (8)
5 Cowboy film (7)
6 In working order (11)
7 Final (4)
12 Statue base (8)
14 Large heavy knife (7)
15 Generosity (6)
16 Active (4)
18 New Age therapy (5)
19 Bill of fare (4)

SOLUTIONS TO LAST SATURDAY'S CROSSWORD

ACROSS:
1 Mist,
3 Rust (Mistrust),
7 Grin,
8 Aperture,
9 Foretold,
10 Puny,
11 September,
15 Mass,
16 Sorcerer,
17 Retiring,
19 Earl,
20 Rank,
21 Slay.

DOWN:
1 Maroon,
2 Senseless,
3 Rut,
4 String,
5 Ragout,
6 Herd,
10 Piecemeal,
12 Mirage,
13 Favela,
14 Nearly,
16 Snip,
18 Ilk.

By arrangement with The Independent Figures in parentheses denote the number of letters in the words required

King Classic Sudoku

4		9	2	7			1	8
8	1	3			9			6
		7			1			
	9		7	6			8	5
3	5				2	6		
	7			3		2		
	3	2					5	
1	4		3	2				
		6	9	4		1	3	

Difficulty: ★★ 6/3

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Solution to yesterday's puzzle

8	4	9	7	1	5	2	6	3
5	1	3	6	2	9	7	4	8
2	6	7	4	3	8	5	9	1
4	7	5	3	8	1	9	2	6
1	3	2	5	9	6	8	7	4
9	8	6	2	4	7	3	1	5
7	2	1	8	5	4	6	3	9
3	9	8	1	6	2	4	5	7
6	5	4	9	7	3	1	8	2

Difficulty: ★ 6/3

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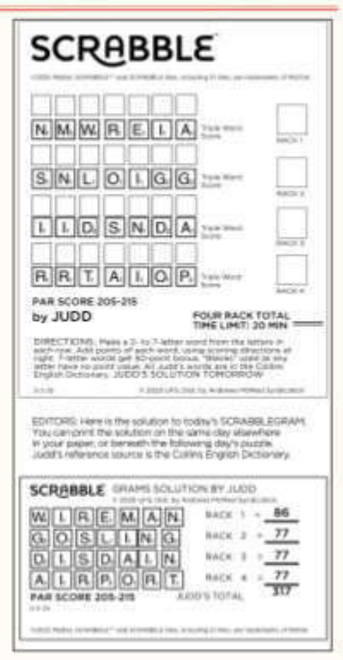
Sudoku is a number placing puzzle based on a 9×9 grid with several given numbers. The object is to place the numbers 1 to 9 in the empty squares so that no row, no column and no 3×3 box contains the same number. The difficulty level increases through the week.

SCRABBLE



NEED TO KNOW

HOSPITALS

- AIIMS 26588500, 26588900
- Moolchand Medcity (formerly Hospital) 42000000 & 24-hour Chemist Shop 42000447
- Vidyasagar Institute for Mental Health and Neuro-Sciences 26924300, 26924304
- Batra Hospital & Medical Research Centre 29051280, 29958747
- Deen Dayal Upadhyay 25496320, 25494403
- Guru Tegh Bahadur 22586262, 22585007

RAILWAY INQUIRY

General Inquiry 139
- Toll Free Nos. 1800112511
- SMS Inquiry Nos. 57886, 54959, 5676747

ROADWAYS INQUIRY

- ISBT (General Inquiry): 23868836, 23865181
- Haryana Roadways 23861262
- Himachal Roadways 23717473, 23325320
- Punjab Roadways 23867842, 23860626
- Rajasthan Roadways 23864470
- U.P. Roadways 23868709

FLIGHT INQUIRY

- AIR INDIA Flight Inquiry and Reservation 18001801407
- INDIGO AIRLINES New Delhi City Office 43513185, Call Centre 09910383838, 18001803838, Reservation 43513186; Indigo Airlines Airport 011-25671580; Terminal I-B 25671576, Palam Road 25671579, 18001803838
- JET AIRWAYS Flight Inquiry and Reservation 39841111
- EMIRATES Flight Inquiry and Reservation 33773377
- Air Canada Flight Inquiry 25656421/25656431 Reservation 41528181
- Air France Flight Inquiry and Reservation 23466262 (City) 25652294 (Airport)
- Kuwait Airways Flight Inquiry and Reservation 23354373

BRIEFLY

Akhilesh Pathak takes charge as Director (Projects) at POWERGRID:

Gurugram: Akhilesh Pathak has officially assumed charge as Director (Projects) at Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (POWERGRID), effective 30 September, 2026. POWERGRID is a Maharatna CPSE operating under the Ministry of Power, Government of India. An Electrical & Electronics Engineering graduate who also completed the Harvard ManageMentor Programme, Shri Pathak joined POWERGRID in 1993 as part of its first Executive Trainee batch. Over a career spanning more than 32 years in the power sector, he has acquired extensive experience in transmission system planning, project execution and management, business development, and strategic infrastructure development. Prior to his new elevation, he served as the company's Executive Director (Project Management). Throughout his career at POWERGRID, Shri Pathak has held multiple key leadership roles involving the development, execution, monitoring, and commissioning of extra-high-voltage (EHV) transmission lines and substations. During his stint in the Project Management Department, he was instrumental in driving POWERGRID to record its highest-ever capital expenditure (CAPEX) utilization, as well as landmark levels in asset capitalization and transmission line additions (circuit kilometers).

Sensex, Nifty fall for fourth straight session amid global headwinds

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

The Indian stock markets on Thursday ended a highly volatile session with the benchmark indices ended lower. Markets continue to extend their losing streak for the fourth consecutive session.

At close, the Sensex was down 570.59 points or 0.79 per cent at 71,909.70, and the Nifty was down 198.50 points or 0.88 per cent at 22,421.95. Nifty Midcap index fell over 1 per cent and Nifty Smallcap index losing nearly 1 per cent.

Multiple factors dragged the markets including depreciating rupee, elevated US Treasury yields, higher crude prices and sustained FII selling weighed on sentiment. Buying was seen in IT stocks.

Among the sectors, Information Technology index added 2 per cent and Telecom index gained 0.5 per cent. On the other hand, Auto, Media, FMCG, Infra, Metal, Consumer Durable and Realty down 2-3 per cent, while Energy, Pharma, PSU Bank, Oil & Gas down more than 1 per cent each.

Over 300 stocks touched 52-week low, including Escorts Kubota, PB Fintech, Gujarat Energy, Bharti Hexacom, M&M, Maruti Suzuki, JK Lakshmi Cement, Bikaji Foods, SJVN, TVS Holdings, DCM Shriram, Godawari Power, ABLBL, Jio Financial, Motherson SWI, India Cements, HUL, Ambuja Cements, P&G Hygiene and Aditya Birla Fashion, among others.

On Nifty, the key losers included Bajaj Auto, Maruti Suzuki, M&M, Adani Enterprises, Adani Ports, while gainers were HDFC Life, SBI Life Insurance, HDFC Bank, Infosys and TCS.

Indian stock markets will remain shut on 2 October on account of Mahatma Gandhi Jayanti.

Among some of the individual performances, Kotak Mahindra Bank shares ended higher after the RBI approved the appointment of Anup Kumar Saha as the bank's new Managing Director and CEO while Highway Infrastructure gained more than 4 per cent.

Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Limited said, "Indian equities had a difficult, holiday-shortened week which saw benchmarks slip below a key psychological level as a worsening global backdrop overwhelmed domestic support. With the crude prices surging, US Treasury yields neared two-decade highs on expectations of further Fed tightening, narrowing the India-US yield differential and weakening the rupee. FIIs stepped up selling through the week, while steady DII buying absorbed much of the outflow, cushioning but not arresting the decline. Broader markets fell as much as frontline indices, while heavy IPO issuance drew liquidity away from listed equities."

"Sectoral weakness was concentrated in rate- and commodity-sensitive segments, with consumer durables, PSU banks, realty and metals under pressure, while autos saw sharper selling following weak wholesale sales data. The IT was the sole gainer, benefiting from rupee depreciation."

Centre tightens sugar stock rules ahead of festive season

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

The government has tightened sugar stockholding norms from 15 October to ensure adequate availability and keep prices under check during the festive season, as the new sugar season begins from 1 October.

Under the revised rules, sugar dealers will be allowed to hold stocks for a maximum of 15 days from the date of receipt. The stockholding limit has also been capped at 1,000 quintals at any location across the country.

The revised restrictions will remain in force from 15 October to 30 November, 2026, with specific exemptions for Kolkata and its extended metropolitan areas and Assam.

For Kolkata and its extended metropolitan areas as well as Assam, the government has set a higher stockholding limit of 2,000 quintals. The higher ceiling has been prescribed in view of the region's supply-chain requirements. Kolkata receives sugar from major producing states such as Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra and Karnataka and acts as a distribution hub for eastern India and the Northeast. In Assam, geographical constraints and transportation challenges have also been taken into account while fixing the higher limit. The government said the revised norms are intended to prevent excessive accumulation of sugar within the distribution chain and facilitate its movement from mills to dealers and ultimately to consumers.

The measure is also aimed at curbing hoarding and speculative trading by limiting both the quantity of sugar that dealers can hold and the duration for which the stocks can be retained. The government's move comes as sugar prices have already softened in recent months.

India embraces market risk, but long-term retirement saving still lags: CEA

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

India's growing participation in equities and mutual funds has not been matched by a similar rise in long-term retirement savings, Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran said, highlighting the need for households to move beyond short-term saving habits as the country's population ages.

Speaking at the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority's (PFRDA) NPS Divas 2026 on Thursday, Nageswaran said Indian savers were increasingly willing to take market-linked risks, but had yet to commit a larger share of their savings for longer periods.

"The Indian saver has shown a willingness to accept market risk—or so we would like to believe," Nageswaran said. However, he added that committing money for a longer tenure represented a different financial decision, noting that Indians generally tend to focus less on long-term financial planning.

The shift in household financial savings towards market-linked instruments has been significant in recent years. According to the Economic Survey 2025-26, equities and mutual funds accounted for about 12-15 per cent of annual household financial savings in FY25, up from around 2 per cent in FY12.

At the same time, the proportion of savings parked in bank deposits fell from more than 58 per cent in FY12 to around 35 per cent in FY25.

Systematic investment plan (SIP) contributions have also expanded sharply. Monthly SIP inflows, which were below Rs 4,000 crore in FY17, crossed Rs 28,000 crore during the first eight months of FY26.

Despite this growing participation in financial markets, pension and insurance assets have not seen a comparable increase in their share of household savings. Nageswaran said their share remained broadly unchanged between FY19 and FY24.

India's pension assets currently stand at around 17 per cent of GDP, significantly below the levels seen across OECD economies, where pension assets are at least 80 per cent of GDP.

The CEA said the changing demographic profile of the country made building adequate retirement savings increasingly

important. As the number of elderly people rises, households will need to accumulate financial resources over longer periods, while financial markets will also have to direct these funds towards productive long-term investments.

Financial Services Secretary Sanjay Lohiya, speaking at the same event, said expanding pension coverage would also require greater confidence among subscribers in the pension system.

He emphasised that retirement savings should be viewed differently from conventional investment products because their primary objective is to provide financial support after an individual stops working.

Lohiya also said contribution-based pension schemes should explore ways to provide subscribers with greater flexibility. Mechanisms that remind subscribers to make regular contributions could also help improve participation and continuity of savings, he added.

Nageswaran pointed to India's demographic transition as another reason for strengthening retirement planning. Citing the United Nations Population Fund's India Ageing Report 2023, he said the proportion of Indians aged 60 years and above stood at 10.1 per cent in 2021 and is projected to reach 15 per cent by 2036 and 28 per cent by 2050.

That would translate into around 34.7 crore Indians aged 60 and above by 2050, underscoring the scale of the retirement-savings challenge.

Life expectancy after retirement is also significant. According to Sample Registration System data cited by Nageswaran, a person reaching the age of 60 can currently expect to live for another 18.4 years on average. For women, the corresponding figure is 19.6 years.

The demographic shift, therefore, is likely to make the ability of households to build and preserve savings over several decades increasingly important, even as Indian investors become more comfortable with market-linked financial products.

India manufacturing PMI hits 7-month high in September on stronger orders, hiring

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

India's private sector manufacturing activity gained momentum in September, with factory output, new orders and employment improving during the month, according to the latest HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI).

The manufacturing PMI climbed to 55.1 in September from 52.8 in August, marking the strongest expansion in seven months. The index has remained above the 50-point mark, which separates growth from contraction, for 59 consecutive months.

The September reading was, however, slightly below the flash estimate of 55.7 released last month. Despite the monthly improvement, the average manufacturing PMI for the second quarter of FY27 stood at 53.8, its weakest level since the corresponding quarter of 2021.

Stronger demand was a key driver of the improvement in manufacturing activity. New orders increased at a faster pace during September, helping factory output record its sharpest growth in four months.

Surveyed companies reported stronger demand for electronic goods, food products, pharmaceuticals and textiles. The increase in overall new business was the fastest since February, indicating a broad-based improvement in demand conditions.

Export demand also strengthened during the month. New export orders rose at a

faster pace, with manufacturers reporting increased business from markets including Brazil, Europe, the United Arab Emirates and the United States.

Among the various categories, intermediate goods recorded the strongest gains in both new orders and output. Capital goods, in contrast, continued to register growth but expanded at a slower pace than in August, making it the weakest-performing segment during the month.

Hiring conditions also improved. After easing in August, employment growth picked up in September, with the pace of job creation reaching its highest level since May.

The improvement in manufacturing activity came alongside renewed cost pressures. Companies reported higher prices for electronic components, pharmaceutical products and steel, resulting in a faster increase in overall input costs compared with August.

Despite the acceleration, input-cost inflation remained below its long-term average. Manufacturers also raised selling prices at a faster pace during September, although the increase remained below the historical trend.

Cost pressures were strongest among intermediate goods producers, while capital goods manufacturers faced the least pressure. Consumer goods producers recorded the sharpest increase in selling prices during the month.

The September PMI data point to a stronger end to the quarter for India's manufacturing sector, with domestic and export demand supporting new business, production and hiring even as input costs continued to rise.

GST collections rise 14.7 per cent in September to over ₹2.03 lakh cr

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

India's gross Goods and Services Tax (GST) revenue continued to show strong growth in September, rising 14.7 per cent year-on-year to more than Rs 2.03 lakh crore, supported by higher collections from both domestic transactions and imports.

Data released for September showed that gross GST revenue from domestic sources increased 10.1 per cent to around Rs 1.38 lakh crore. GST collected on imports recorded a sharper 26 per cent rise, reaching Rs 65,525 crore during the month.

The government's GST receipts remained strong even after accounting for refunds. Refunds issued in September stood at Rs 27,001 crore, around 3 per cent lower than the

DATA RELEASED FOR SEPTEMBER SHOWED THAT GROSS GST REVENUE FROM DOMESTIC SOURCES INCREASED 10.1 PER CENT TO AROUND RS 1.38 LAKH CR

corresponding month last year. As a result, net GST collections increased 18.1 per cent to about Rs 1.77 lakh crore, compared with nearly Rs 1.50 lakh crore a year earlier.

Domestic net GST revenue rose 13.5 per cent to around Rs 1.24 lakh crore. Net GST revenue from imports, meanwhile, jumped 30.8 per cent to Rs 52,028 crore.

The September numbers take the total gross GST collection for the first six months of FY27 to Rs 12.46 lakh crore, marking an 11.6 per cent increase over the Rs 11.17 lakh crore collected during the April-September period of the previous financial year.

Domestic gross GST collections during the first half of FY27 grew 6.1 per cent to Rs 8.74 lakh crore. Revenue from imports recorded significantly faster growth of 27.1 per cent, reaching Rs 3.72 lakh crore.

On a net basis, GST revenue for April-September rose 10.4 per cent to Rs 10.66 lakh crore. However, refunds during the six-month period increased 18.8 per cent year-on-year to Rs 1.80 lakh crore.

The September figures also highlight the impact of lower refunds on net tax collections. While gross GST revenue recorded a healthy increase during the month, the decline in refunds resulted in net revenue growing at a faster pace.

ICMAI unveils INSCOST framework to strengthen cost governance in insurance sector

NIKHIL VYAS
New Delhi, 1 October

The Institute of Cost Accountants of India (ICMAI) on Thursday unveiled the first edition of its "INSCOST – Cost Management, Cost Governance, Cost Disclosure and Cost Assurance Framework for the Indian Insurance Sector", a sector-specific framework aimed at strengthening cost discipline, transparency, governance and assurance across the insurance industry.

The publication is the First Edition, 2026, brought out by The Institute of Cost Accountants of India (ICMAI).

CMA Chittaranjan Chattopadhyay, President, ICMAI, stated, "I am pleased to present this Framework at an important stage in the evolution of the Indian insurance sector. As India advances towards the vision of 'Insurance for All by 2047' and the broader objective of Viksit Bharat, sound cost management and cost governance will be increasingly important for efficiency, sustainability and policyholder value."

On the occasion, CMA Manoj Anand, Vice President, ICMAI, said, "The INSCOST Framework is designed to bring a sharper focus on the role of cost information in strengthening decision-making across the insurance value chain. By enabling insurers to understand and manage costs at the product, process and operational levels, the Framework can support greater efficiency, transparency and sustainable profitability while strengthening value for policyholders."

The INSCOST Framework addresses an important structural requirement by providing a dedicated and sector-specific body of guidance covering cost records, cost management, cost governance, cost disclosure and cost assurance, while also extending into strategic cost management and product profitability. During the presentation, ICMAI highlighted the framework as the first comprehensive sub-sector differentiated work of its kind globally, covering Life, General, Health, Reinsurance and Public-Sector insurance entities.

From L to R: CMA (Dr.) P. Siva Rama Prasad; CMA Rajendra Singh Bhati, Council Member, ICMAI; CMA Manoj Kumar Anand, Vice President, ICMAI; CMA Chittaranjan Chattopadhyay, President, ICMAI; CMA Ashok Jain; CMA Lalit Wadhwa, Advisor (Cost), Ministry of Health & Family Welfare; CMA Shambhu Nath Roy.

The framework adapts the established Cost Accounting Standards, Cost Auditing Standards and Generally Accepted Cost Accounting Principles of ICMAI to the distinctive economics of insurance and aligns them with the regulatory architecture of the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI). It provides guidance on cost allocation, Expenses of Management, claims and distribution costs, bancassurance, government-sponsored schemes, strategic cost analytics and product profitability.

A key focus highlighted during the presentation was the need for the insurance sector to give greater attention to cost management alongside claims management. Effective control and governance of acquisition, procurement and other operational costs can support underwriting discipline and help insurers work towards greater efficiency and profitability in their core insurance business.

The Framework also seeks to support more cost-effective insurance products and wider insurance penetration. It positions cost not merely as an accounting number but as an important management and governance parameter, encouraging insurers to assess what drives their costs, whether processes are efficient, whether product costs are aligned with value and whether management decisions are supported by reliable cost information.

The Framework further introduces a Cost Maturity Model and phased Implementation Roadmap, enabling insurers to progressively strengthen their cost management and assurance practices in accordance with their size and readiness. It also highlights the expanding role of Cost and Management Accountants in areas such as product-level profitability, claims cost analysis, operational efficiency, distribution cost management, process optimisation, budgeting and strategic decision-making.

The publication is particularly timely in the context of the IRDAI Public Consultation Paper on "Reforms for Recalibrating Economics of Insurance Distribution" issued on 23 September 2026, which has significant relevance to cost rationalisation, Expenses of Management, commission structures, cost transparency and cost audit.

"I commend the INSCOST Framework to insurers, Boards of Directors, regulators, practitioners and the wider professional community. I believe this initiative will contribute to stronger cost governance and create meaningful opportunities for Cost and Management Accountants to support the evolving insurance sector," the President added.

Indian Cinema- Path to Global Recognition

CHAITANYA K. PRASAD

In our multipolar world, cinema has become a critical component of soft power, shaping global. perceptions through its captivating narratives. Movies have evolved far beyond mere entertainment; they now play a significant role in global politics and cultural relations. Through creative expressions, films harness the ecosystem comprising key stakeholders to nurture and develop soft power dynamics and geopolitical equations. In the realm of geopolitics, movies are more than art; they are potent tools used by countries to showcase their soft power and expand their influence worldwide.

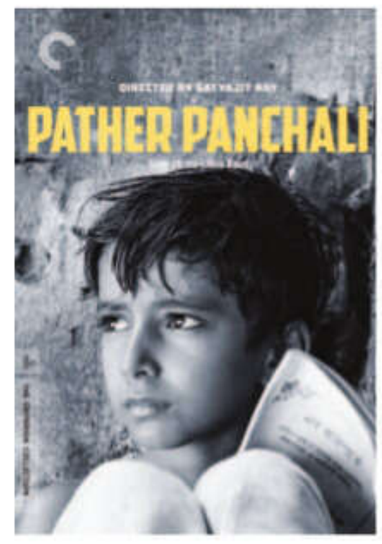
Indian storytelling captivates and inspire audiences worldwide. With the right strategy, this moment can shape the future of Indian cinema. The Namaste at the Oscars 2025 had reinforced the idea of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam: "The world is one family," a vision that transcends borders yet thrives on respect, mutual interdependence and a shared spirit of creativity. This symbolic gesture was not merely a greeting but a powerful moment of inclusivity, reflecting cinema's unique ability to bring together artists, audiences and creators from across the globe.

A simple, well-timed Namaste gave Incredible India a renewed global identity, transforming its participation in world cinema from occasional recognition to strategic influence. It was more than a greeting-it was a defining moment for Indian cinema on the global stage. It symbolised India's growing influence in storytelling, marking a shift from sporadic recognition to strategic presence.

Indian cinema of late has been given the due recognition and place within the global film fraternity and landscape. While awards, accolades and triumphs have started trickling down with frequency, the buzz has not yet captured the podium finish dream. Something is amiss, there is a consistency gap in our cinematic brilliance not capturing defining moments in the global space. What is required perhaps is to rescript India's cinematic roadmap, in order to address these missing links and reach out to the stakeholders who matter today. To tap the global arena, audiences, stakeholders, we need a structured policy and approach. An approach that is multi-layered, multi-pronged and multi-dimensional. A framework that takes our cinema to global screens not only through awards & festivals, by becoming a model of excellence for the cinephiles and the "Creator's Economy", a much talked about concept today.

To begin with, we need a SWOT analysis of our structure and design. There has to be a deep and insightful understanding of how Indian cinema, through its diverse institutions, policies and structures is a force to reckon with at festivals, distribution network and a global campaigns, as soft-power, branding and stakeholder collaboration. India's diversity in storytelling is second to none. The richness of our filmic tapestry gives us the vibrancy, shine, and reach which very few countries, networks can match. Despites these positives, the international positioning of Indian storytelling has not captured the podium. Let us explore ways, methods and ideas to suggest a 'Way Forward for Indian Cinema'.

To begin with we need a cinema first strategy to capture the sublime mood, matrix and authenticity of Indian storytelling through the cinematic lens. Our strategy at times is based on ad-hocism, which ignores perfection, timeliness and coherence. A case in point is our elusive dream to win an 'Oscars' through an official Indian nomination. Winning an Oscar requires a deep, well thought out strategy, incorporating touch points that will create a lasting impact. Our thrust should be to design a calibrated strategy with clear goals, mechanisms and support for maximizing our reach to critical stakeholders. The Oscar and related awards have to be conducted in a 'Mission Mode' where every stage is integrated into the mission objective of achieving the dream of excellence. If South Korea could orchestrate a global push for Parasite (2019), resulting in its historic Oscar win, India must now do the same,



systematically pushing its best films into the international awards circuit.

Strategic communication must be part of the mission mode process. A strategy that translates the reach of Indian cinema, its creators to audiences through innovative methods. We need to inculcate cinema hubs at major filming touch points, promote Indian films festival week through MEA, reach out to academic's university, film clubs, in an effort to build a sense of Indian cinema, translating India's storytelling to talking heads across the world. This strategy would also entail linkages with prominent film schools, co-production houses & utilising diaspora fraternity across the globe. International visibility will grow if India's diverse cinema voices are promoted & inculcated as priceless assets as part of the international branding and visibility exercise. Understanding of Indian cinema will improve only when cinephiles globally are involved as part of the global talent and marketing process. It is important that the I&B Ministry of Govt. of India creates the channels, avenues and platforms to promote this mission mode through National Film Awards & IFFI, these two platforms may be seen as "Gateways to the Global Architecture" of storytelling and branding at Film festivals and global markets. A Mission Mode structure should include elements that echo - Excellence, Consistency, Continuity, Experimentation, New Talent, Voices, Technology and Innovations. All these combined leading to stories that appeal to audiences. The organisation of waves and waves bazar has given the needed push, yet more concrete milestones need to be adopted to reach the mission mode vision and goal of India being a hub of cinema.

The need of the hour is a structured approach to Indian cinema. Which combines visibility, outreach, awareness through the 4C's Content, Creativity, Cultural Connect and Conversations. A mission mode needs to break the shackles of traditional modes of nomination and selection of films for film festivals. We need to fast track creativity that is led by content matching global standards rather than hype. The Challenge before strategists positioning Indian cinema is to globalise India's presence through content discovery & distinct storytelling. Indian cinema needs to energise cinematic imagination through the lens of Creators, Innovators and Entrepreneurs. The India of today striving to achieve excellence needs to push cinema as a brand, identity and platform globally.

Cinema transcends power structures by influencing through its captivating narratives. Movies serve as public opinion and shaping international policies platforms for discussions and political analysis, sparking conversations that can drive societal transformation. Filmmakers and actors act as ambassadors with significant sway, using their facilitate cultural exchange works to and international conversations. Cinema has become a platform for new ideas and concepts, driving integration through International Film Festivals and Awards. The role of cinema in today's world is incredibly significant. It serves as a diplomatic tool and a compelling medium to communicate ideas through storytelling, influencing international relationships. Beyond its audience, cinema has a far-reaching impact on global leaders, policymakers, and communities worldwide. It acts as an envoy, spreading messages of peace, empathy, and solidarity through engaging stories that mirror the complexities of human life. There is no doubt that cinema now transcends entertainment in contemporary society. Nations are recognising the power of cinema as a tool to promote their agendas and perspectives on the world stage, underscoring its importance in diplomacy. Indian cinema needs this perspective.

THE AUTHOR IS A COMMENTATOR AND WRITER ON CINEMA, BRANDING, MEDIA MANAGEMENT AND GEO-STRATEGIC COMMUNICATION. (VIEWS ARE PERSONAL.) INPUTS PROVIDED BY ZOYA AHMAD AND VAISHNAVIE SRINIVASAN

Gandhi, the Visionary

SANDIP BANERJEE

It is a natural propensity to try and evaluate an individual in the light of his or her prominent deeds or actions. While doing so we tend to overlook the lesser exposed dimensions of such an individual's multifaceted talents. To the majority of us Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi is a politician, mass leader and above all a freedom fighter who surprisingly and in exemplary manner chose non -violence as a means of struggle. But Gandhi's views pronounce his multi-dimensional nature as a social philosopher. He has shared his ideas on education, on village-development, on social-injustices and economic disparity. He has even in the capacity of an editor of as many as six newspapers in various languages, demonstrated his understanding of public communication. However, few

would actually know about Gandhi's approach to development in the light of environment awareness and sustainable development. Gandhiji throughout his life, in his socio-economic conception, relied on the principle of growth with distributive justice. During his lifetime the terms

ecology or sustainable development were not so much a part of vocabulary. When we read Gandhiji's writings, quiet expectedly we do not come across such terms. Only a careful reading, perhaps, between the lines makes it evident that while dealing with many socio-economic issues Gandhiji did focus his thoughts on the subject of environment trying to reach for solutions to the problems.

OPINION

Gandhii's interest in environment can be noticed in his writings on subjects like industrialisation, urbanisation, village life and so many others. These points are mentioned in his "Hind Swaraj". Gandhi was not an arm-chair intellect; rather he was practical enough to realise that development must suit local needs and must follow the idiom of changing circumstances.

As a thinker Gandhi was ahead of his generation. Today we are talking about Kyoto Protocol or about Earth Summit; Gandhiji alerted us wayback in 1927 when he stated that contemporary Western Civilisation was dehumanising the individual. His indictment of the modern civilisation in 'Hind Swaraj' was intended to caution mankind against this calamity. In modern times, particularly in an era of cultural impact of globalisation of the economy, when materialism is no more an economic content but a psychological determinant we are bound to taste the bitterness of disparity and economic discrimination. Gandhiji anticipated this long back and hence made a historic comment that seems to grow in relevance every day - "The world has enough for everyone's needs but not everyone's greed".

Gandhiji advocated the concept of simple living and high thinking. He could distinguish between happiness and material comfort. He firmly believed that consumerism is not the only essential key to development. Gandhian model of village development that met criticism even from thinkers like Dr. Ambedkar, still holds pertinence. Gandhiji's ideas about economic sustenance rested on planning where the governance can unite itself with the mass and create a transparent model of economic development.

Scientific progress directing the path of rapid industrialisatiion and urbanisation have certainly deteriorated the environ in which we live. While exploiting the natural resources for our comforts we have actually eroded the fabric of nature. The result is bound to be detrimental. We are all using terminologies like global warming. But Gandhiji was apprehensive about such an outcome long ago. He thus had faith on revival of our traditional cottage industries for to him unchecked exploitation of natural resources would lead to environmental problems. Gandhiji's analysis of the psyche of modern man convinced him that modern civilisation would grow at the cost of ecological imbalance where nature would be put to stake. Time has proved him proverbially correct.

Prof Amartya Sen in his economic vision has stated the link between environment and sustainable development. He provided examples like Kalahandi in Orissa where rapid and arbitrary industrialization endangered the livelihood of the native tribals. Modern economics explains how sustainable development speaks of human attitude to nature. Sustainable development is an integrated form of human development, participatory

in nature. It relates to reconciliation with nature where equity and justice are the major premises. Gandhiji's views on development and environment embrace all the major value premises and components of sustainable development. Gandhian model of social development highlights the importance of value -systems in our lives. Gandhiji believed in emancipation of the mind; to ensure all-round development of the society where the 'Last Man' enjoys the fruits of development. In recent times we have toiled hard to find a parity between growth and distributive justice. There is no scope for continuing economic sustainability by creating islands of excellence. According to Gandhi, for attaining smooth development of the economy, it is imperative to develop all the regions of the country simultaneously. The overall progress of the entire economy depends on the balanced development of all the regions. In this context, Gandhian economics is relevant for it supports the attainment of self-sufficiency level in industrialization and uniform economic pattern for each region. The Gandhian economics justifies that every man should increase his personal income and standard of living by exploiting the existing natural and human resources fully in an eco-friendly manner.

One point criticism of Gandhi's ideas has been that that he opposed scientific and technological progress. Some critics even suggest that he glorified poverty. He has also been criticized of redirecting the outlook of the people towards past practices. However. a finer look into Gandhiji's economics reveals that he was not opposed to industrialisatin. Neither was he opposed to science and technology. In 'Harijan', he clearly wrote, "There would be no objection to villagers using even the modern machines and tools that they can make and afford to use." Nowadays environmentalists vindicate that future of humanity rests on factors like man's behaviour with himself, his behaviour with fellow beings and his relationship with nature. These are also taken to be vital parameters for sustainable development and economic growth in holistic terms. Gandhian philosophy deals with all these and that too almost a century back. It is time to interpret and reappraise the ideas of Gandhiji in the context of modern time and space. The emphasis on encompassing every available resources without denting their basic texture is what Gandhi spoke about. This is exactly what modern economists opine about sustainable development. Re -interpreting Gandhi in the light of modern thought can be a yardstick in measuring the effects of development with ecological balance.

THE WRITER IS AN ACADEMIC AND EDUCATOR

'Manifesting to feature in 2027 WC'

Outlining his long-term ambition to feature in the ICC World Cup 2027, Rohit Sharma says his strategy revolves around staying strictly in the present. "What I want to manifest is that I keep myself capable enough until 2027, so I keep myself fit, keep working hard, and keep performing well in every tournament that comes up," Rohit said.

India bag six medals on Day 12, tally rises to 66

TRIDIB BAPARNASH
New Delhi, 1 October

Nitesh Siwach became the first Indian Greco-Roman wrestler in 64 years to win an Asian Games silver as India collected six medals on a packed Day 12 in Aichi-Nagoya on Thursday. The 23-year-old reached the men's 97kg final before losing 0-4 to Japan's Yuri Nakazato, ending India's wait for a Greco-Roman wrestling finalist since the 1962 edition.

India's medal haul also included silver for sailors Manu Francis and Prince Kurisinkal Noble in the men's skiff, bronze for the women's skiff pair Harshita Tomar and Shital Verma, and bronze medals for the men's and women's squash teams. Ganesh Mani Ratnam Thirumuru added a bronze in the men's individual compound archery event.

The six medals took India's tally to 66 (10 gold, 23 silver and 33 bronze) as the country remained eighth in the standings. China continued to lead with 289 medals, including 155 gold, followed by Japan with 218 and South Korea with 113.

Nitesh Siwach claims silver in men's 97kg Greco Roman. AGENCIES

Indian players celebrate a goal against Pakistan during the hockey semi-final match at the Asian Games 2026, in Gifu on Thursday. AGENCIES

Nitesh scripts wrestling history: Nitesh's historic run ended with a silver after Nakazato produced a controlled performance in the 97kg final at the Nagoya City Inae Sports Center. The Japanese wrestler opened the scoring by pushing Nitesh out of the mat. Nitesh attempted a two-on-one grip but could not breach Nakazato's defence and was later put into the ground position for passivity. The Indian defended well and denied his opponent a clear opportunity to score with a gut wrench.

Nakazato led 2-0 at the end of the first period and continued to keep Nitesh under pressure. He eventually disbalanced the Indian with a push and converted it into a takedown to extend his advantage. Nitesh was forced to attack in the final minute but could not find a way past Nakazato, who held on for the gold.

Earlier, Mansi Ahlawat missed out on a medal in the women's 62kg category after losing 2-5 to Mongolia's Altjin Togtokh in the bronze-medal bout.

Sailing adds two medals: Kerala sailors Manu Francis and Prince Kurisinkal Noble secured India's first Asian Games silver in the men's skiff, finishing the nine-race competition with 23 net points. China's Liu Tian and Wen Zaiding won gold with 16, while Hong Kong took bronze with 24. The Indian pair won Race 3 and finished second in Races 1, 5 and 9. Their sixth-place finish in Race 8 was discarded under the low-point scoring system.

India also won bronze in the women's skiff after Harshita Tomar and Shital Verma were upgraded from fourth following a successful protest. The Indian pair finished with 24 net points, behind gold medallists Japan and silver winners Hong Kong.

Ganesh adds another archery medal: Ganesh Mani Ratnam Thirumuru beat Vietnam's Dang Cong Duc 149-144 in the men's compound individual bronze-medal contest. The Indian produced a perfect finish with three successive 10s to pull clear and secure his second medal of the Games. India ended the compound archery competition with three gold medals from the team events and Ganesh's individual bronze.

Hockey teams reach finals: Defending champions India survived a dramatic Pakistan fightback to win their men's hockey semifinal 4-3 and book a place in the gold-medal match.
Skipper Harmanpreet Singh scored twice and Sukhjeet Singh was also on target before Pakistan erased a three-goal deficit. Abhishek then scored the winner in the dying minute to send India through.

The result means India's men's and women's teams will both contest the hockey finals at the same Asian Games for the first time since 1998.

Sepak takraw assure medal: India's men's quadrant team completed an unbeaten group-stage campaign with a 2-1 comeback win over Myanmar. After losing the opening game 10-15, India responded with 15-13 and 15-7 wins to top Group A and enter the semifinals, assuring themselves of a medal. They had earlier beaten the Lao People's Democratic Republic and Vietnam.

Squash teams settle for bronze: India's men's team picked bronze after losing 1-2 to Malaysia in the semifinal. Abhay Singh lost 8-11, 8-11, 8-11 to Ng Eain Yow before Veer Chotrani beat Sanjay Jeeva 11-4, 11-8, 11-5 to level the tie. Velavan Senthilkumar then lost 12-10, 6-11, 8-11, 9-11 to Ameeshenraj Chandaran in the deciding match.

The women's team also took bronze after their semi-final defeat.

Other results: India marched into the men's cricket final with a commanding 124-run win over Sri Lanka, setting up a gold-medal clash against Pakistan. In golf, Saptak Talwar was tied seventh at six-under 134 after two rounds of the men's individual stroke play. Veer Ahlawat was tied 16th at one-under 139, while Yuvraj Sandhu was tied 22nd at even-par 140.

In shooting, Anish Bhanwala finished seventh in the men's 25m rapid-fire pistol final after being eliminated on countback on 11 points.

Judo's India campaign also ended on Thursday, with Inunganbi Takhellambam losing her women's -70kg bronze-medal bout to Mongolia's Anujin Ulzii-Uran.

ICC rolls out new playing rules across formats

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

THE CHANGES CAME INTO EFFECT FOR INTERNATIONAL SERIES BEGINNING ON OCTOBER 1 OR LATER, WHILE ONGOING SERIES WILL CONTINUE UNDER THE PREVIOUS REGULATIONS. ICC MEN'S CRICKET COMMITTEE CHAIR SOURAV GANGULY SAID THE CHANGES WERE AIMED AT KEEPING THE LAWS ALIGNED WITH THE MODERN GAME.

The International Cricket Council (ICC) has introduced a series of changes to its Playing Conditions, covering time-wasting, ball specifications, fielding laws and several format-specific regulations.

The changes came into effect for international series beginning on October 1 or later, while ongoing series will continue under the previous regulations. ICC men's cricket committee chair Sourav Ganguly said the changes were aimed at keeping the laws aligned with the modern game.

"There are some important changes to the Playing Conditions, including provisions relating to cricket balls, greater clarity around certain aspects of fielding and measures aimed at improving the pace of the game.

"These changes have been carefully considered to ensure the Playing Conditions continue to reflect the needs of the modern game while maintaining its integrity and consistency," the former India skipper said.

According to the new rules, batters who are not ready to face the ball within the prescribed time will now receive a warning for the first offence and a final warning for the second. A third and every subsequent offence will result in five penalty runs for the fielding side. Repeated offences can also attract action under the Code of Conduct.

The new rules also suggested changes on the size and weight of balls. The ICC has introduced separate size and weight specifications for men's, women's and junior cricket balls. Previously, manufacturers often used a single ball for women's and junior cricket, with limited tolerances permitted.

The definition of an overthrow has also been clarified. An overthrow is an attempt to direct the ball towards the stumps to prevent runs or effect a run-out, while a misfield does not qualify as an overthrow. Umpires will also have greater discretion in deciding when a ball is finally settled. It no longer necessarily has to be in the bowler's or wicketkeeper's hands.

For a fielder to be considered to have held the ball during a run-out or stumping, complete control is required. Merely touching the ball with a hand as it breaks the stumps will not be enough.

Changes in Test cricket: Pink balls may be used in daytime Tests on a trial basis if both teams agree before the match, primarily to reduce interruptions caused by bad light. Once agreed, the decision cannot be reversed during the Test.

According to the new rules, play will also no longer automatically end when a wicket falls during the final over of the day if the over remains incomplete and conditions are suitable. The remaining deliveries will instead be completed.

ODI and T20I changes: T20Is will now have a fixed 15-minute innings interval, which can be reduced to a minimum of 10 minutes if time has been lost. In ODIs and T20Is, the head coach or a designated member of the coaching staff can now enter the field during drinks intervals.

The wide-ball rule previously trialled in limited-overs cricket has also been made permanent. The batter's leg position at the point of delivery will be used as the reference for judging a wide, even if the batter subsequently moves across to the off side.

India, Pakistan set up Asian Games cricket final

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi, 1 October

Defending champions India stormed into the men's cricket final at the Asian Games with a commanding 124-run win over Sri Lanka, setting up a blockbuster gold-medal clash against Pakistan in Nisshin on 3 October.

India's victory was built around a disciplined bowling effort after Ishan Kishan's unbeaten 80 had helped them post 169/7. Sri Lanka were then blown away for just 45 in 9.4 overs, with Jasprit Bumrah, Axar Patel, Ravi Bishnoi and Washington Sundar sharing the damage as India secured a place in the summit clash.

India were given an early setback after Sri Lanka opted to bowl, with Abhishek Sharma falling to Sahan Arachchige in the opening over. Sanju Samson followed soon after, dismissed by Tharindu Ratnayake to leave India at 24/2.

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, however, counter-attacked with a brisk 38 off 21 balls, giving the innings some momentum before Arachchige accounted for him in the seventh over. Shreyas Iyer then departed for 13, leaving India needing another partnership to build a competitive total.

That responsibility was taken up by Kishan and Axar Patel. Kishan, batting at No. 5, found his range quickly and struck five sixes and four boundaries in an unbeaten 80 off 46 balls. His assault in the latter half of the innings lifted India to 169/7 from their 20 overs.

Sri Lanka's chase lasted barely four overs as India's bowlers ran through their batting line-up.

Bumrah set the tone by removing Sineth Jayawardena and Sohan de Livera without scoring in the first over. Ravi Bishnoi then produced a direct hit to run out Lasith Croospulle, leaving Sri Lanka at 2/3 after 1.1 overs.

Axar compounded the damage in the fourth over, dismissing captain Arachchige and Ashen Bandara to reduce Sri Lanka to 12/5. Another run-out, this time involving Nuwanidu Fernando, left the chase in complete disarray.

Washington Sundar and Abhishek Sharma then cleaned up the lower order as Sri Lanka were bowled out for 45 in just 9.4 overs. Fernando, with 10, was the only batter to reach double figures.

Pakistan edge Bangladesh to set up final: Pakistan booked their place in the gold-medal match after overcoming Bangladesh in a low-scoring semifinal, winning with four balls to spare in a 13-over-a-side contest.

Bangladesh, sent in after Pakistan chose to field, struggled against the spin of Arafat Minhas and Saim Ayub and were reduced to 21/3 in the fourth over. Towhid Hridoy provided some resistance with 42 off 25 balls, but Sufyan Moqim's three-wicket haul prevented Bangladesh from building a bigger total as they finished on 111/7.

Pakistan's chase also wobbled early, with Mahedi Hasan, Nasum Ahmed, Rishad Hossain and Mustafizur Rahman each taking a wicket. At 53/4 at the start of the seventh over, Bangladesh were in the contest.

Abdul Samad, however, changed the course of the chase with an unbeaten 30 off 15 balls, including five fours and a six. He combined with Hasan Nawaz, who made 27 not out off 22, for an unbeaten 59-run partnership to take Pakistan into the final. India and Pakistan will now meet for the Asian Games gold medal on Saturday, with Bangladesh and Sri Lanka playing the bronze-medal match earlier in the day.

'This is not cricket, this is only batting': Gautam Gambhir urges fairer contest for bowlers after Guwahati run-fest

STATESMAN NEWS SERVICE
Guwahati, 1 October

The second ODI between India and the West Indies at the Assam Cricket Association (ACA) Stadium here, could go down as one of the epics in cricketing folklore and was certainly pleasing for the fans, with India breaking several records while chasing down a mammoth 406 on the back of a double century from Shubman Gill and a century from Rohit Sharma. But India head coach Gautam Gambhir feels differently.

For the former India opener, the run-fest in Guwahati only highlighted the need for a better balance between bat and ball, with bowlers getting little assistance from a surface that produced more than 800 runs and five centuries.

"There has to be a bit more of a contest between bat and ball, because I think you talk about cricket -- but this is not cricket, this is only batting," Gambhir said.

"Imagine a young bowler bowling on this wicket, and the opposition getting 400 and then we go on to chase 400. For the records it's outstanding, for the crowd it's outstanding, for the broadcaster it's outstanding, but as a genuine cricket fan and as a coach, I have to have sympathy for the bowlers as well," Gambhir added.

Gambhir said bowlers should not be judged purely by their figures when conditions provide virtually no assistance. "When you bowl on this kind of a wicket, it's not fair for the bowlers. So we've got to give something to the bowlers so there's at least something which the bowlers can work with," he said. "You can't be hard on bowlers, because sometimes bowling figures are such that they haven't bowled as poorly as their figures suggest."

The India coach also pointed to the demands already placed on bowlers in modern ODI cricket, including fielding restrictions, two new balls and increasingly aggressive batting. He believes pitches offering some assistance would help create a more even contest.

India keen to test options: With the 2027 ODI World Cup approaching, Gambhir said India need to use the current period to assess different players and combinations.

"Right now is the time for us to try different options," he said.

"Just like Auqib (Nabi) got an opportunity, we will similarly try, at least until the Zimbabwe series, to give other people an opportunity and see what they can offer us in this format."

India have taken an unassailable 2-0 lead in the three-match series, with the final ODI scheduled for New Chandigarh on Saturday.

Prasidh ruled out of third ODI: India will be without fast bowler Prasidh Krishna for the third ODI after he sustained a left hamstring injury during the Guwahati match. The men's selection committee named Anshul Kamboj as his replacement, with the pacer set to join the squad in Chandigarh.

India's updated ODI squad: Shubman Gill (C), Rohit Sharma, Virat Kohli, Ruturaj Gaikwad, KL Rahul (VC, WK), Dhruv Jurel (WK), Nitish Kumar Reddy, Ravindra Jadeja, Kuldeep Yadav, Gurnoor Brar, Mohammed Siraj, Auqib Nabi, Yashasvi Jaiswal, Naman Dhir, Anshul Kamboj.

Washington withdrawn from T20I squad: Meanwhile, spin-bowling all-rounder Washington Sundar has also been withdrawn from India's T20I squad for the upcoming series against the West Indies. The decision was taken with the Test series against New Zealand in mind.

With the Ranji Trophy season beginning on October 11, the Tamil Nadu off-spinner will return to domestic cricket and get an opportunity to prepare for the red-ball series. Naman Dhir has been named as his replacement in the T20I squad.

Washington is currently in Japan for the Asian Games, as defending champions India mauled Sri Lanka in the semifinal to set up a gold-medal clash with Pakistan, who beat Bangladesh by six wickets in the other semifinal.

India's updated T20I squad: Shreyas Iyer (C), Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Ishan Kishan (WK), Sanju Samson (WK), Tilak Varma (VC), Shivam Dube, Kuldeep Yadav, Axar Patel, Ravi Bishnoi, Nitish Kumar Reddy, Arshdeep Singh, Prince Yadav, Mayank Yadav, Naman Dhir

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